

Bar X Ranch

Four-Lot Feasibility Portfolio

Land acquisition and a five-bedroom build on four vacant lots in Bar X Ranch, unincorporated Brazoria County, Angleton, Texas 77515 — assessed for buildability, cost, flood and windstorm exposure, and what it is actually like to live there.

WHAT IS NEW IN THIS EDITION

Every one of the four lots has now been **identified in the county record** — parcel ID, legal description, acreage of record, appraised value, deed reference — and checked against the county's own flood, LiDAR elevation, taxing-district and subdivision layers, the USDA soil survey, and the recorded deed restrictions. This edition adds **true-scale plans and terrain sections** for each lot (§11–15) and a chapter on **what living here is actually like** (§23–27). Nineteen open questions are closed, and **four conclusions change**: the FIRM panel, the governing base flood elevation, which lot is the best buy, and whether you can keep poultry.

PREPARED FOR	Mohsin Chowdhury
DATE	11 September 2026
VERSION	3.0 — supersedes v2.0 (10 Sep 2026) and the original generated portfolio
SUBJECT	PID 183667 · 183367 · 186219 · 183332 — Bar X Ranch Sections 1, 2 and 16
ASKING PRICE	\$234,500 for 5.25 acres of record across four lots
BASIS	Primary regulation, Brazoria County public GIS, FEMA, TCEQ, TDI, TWIA, USDA soil survey, USGS 3DEP and hydrography, US Census ACS 2024, ERA5 climate reanalysis
STATUS	Desktop study. No survey, no soil test, no written county flood determination.

THE NUMBER THAT CHANGED THE ENGINEERING

The nearest **published base flood elevation** on the effective FIRM is **28 ft NAVD88**, not the 24 ft assumed by both earlier editions. County LiDAR puts natural ground at these parcels at **24–28 ft**. Brazoria County requires a finished floor 24 in above BFE — so the target is **30 ft**, which is **2 to 6 ft above existing grade**. Building at grade is not an option on any of the four. See §10.

THE FINDINGS THAT CHANGED THE ANSWER

Two of the four lots sit on **Pledger clay** — a 70% clay shrink-swell vertisol, hydrologic group D — and two on **Asa silty clay loam**, a well-drained prime-farmland loam (§16). And the pad, now **calculated per lot** rather than estimated, ranges from **\$20,400 on Lot 2 to \$58,200 on Lot 4** at mid-case (§20). Together those outweigh every asking-price gap in the portfolio.

AND THE FINDING YOU NEED BEFORE YOU DO ANYTHING ELSE

The recorded restrictions allow one dwelling, one garage and **one horse barn** per lot, and bar **“livestock of any kind other than house pets”** apart from horses. **Chickens and ducks are very unlikely to be permitted**. See §1 and §17.

This document is a desktop screening study prepared from published regulation and public records. It is not a survey, an engineering opinion, a flood determination, insurance advice, legal advice or an appraisal. Read the disclaimer on the final page before relying on any figure in it.

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HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Every material figure carries a confidence chip. They are not decoration — the chips are the point of the document, because the original portfolio presented estimates and errors in the same typeface as facts.

VERIFIED traced to a primary or official source and reproduced here **UNVERIFIED** from listing copy or a superseded edition; not confirmed

ESTIMATE a ranged planning figure, not a quote **NEW IN V3** established for the first time in this edition

WHERE THE NEW EVIDENCE CAME FROM

Brazoria County publishes its GIS as an open ArcGIS service. This edition queries it directly for the parcel record, the FEMA flood layers, the LiDAR elevation contours, the taxing districts and the recorded subdivision instruments, then cross-checks the results against FEMA, TCEQ, TDI, TWIA, the US Census and OpenStreetMap. Every query is written down in docs/EVIDENCE.md so it can be re-run and disputed. The parcel polygons are committed to the repository as data/parcels.geojson.

THREE THINGS THIS DOCUMENT STILL CANNOT TELL YOU

- **The soil class.** It decides whether the septic system costs \$8,000 or \$25,000 — the single largest controllable cost swing in the project — and it can only be answered by a site and soil evaluation on the specific lot.
- **The distance to three-phase power at each lot.** \$0 or \$25,000.
- **The site-specific BFE in writing.** §10 narrows it hard, but only the Brazoria County Floodplain Administration can issue the determination a lender and an insurer will accept.

1 • Verdict and recommendation

You asked which one lot to buy and build on, weighted for gardening, hobby farming, scenery, a good developed neighbourhood, quick access to amenities and safety from flood and storm. Two findings in this edition decide it, and neither was in any earlier version.

READ THIS BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE — POULTRY LOOKS PROHIBITED

The recorded Bar X Ranch declaration of restrictions permits, on any lot, exactly **three structures**: one single-family dwelling, a garage, and **one horse barn** of no more than 30 × 25 ft (\$3.01). And §3.15 provides that “**no livestock of any kind other than house pets of reasonable kind and number may be kept on any Lot**”, adding horses as the one express exception, on an acreage formula.

Chickens and ducks are neither house pets nor horses. On the face of the instrument, keeping them would need a written variance from the committee for the structure *and* a departure from the livestock clause. If poultry is non-negotiable for you, the honest answer is that **Bar X Ranch is the wrong subdivision** — buy unrestricted acreage in Brazoria County instead. Horses, unusually, are welcome: 1 per 32,670 sq ft, 2 per 42,000 sq ft.

IF YOU BUY HERE ANYWAY, BUY LOT 2 — 336 WAGON WHEEL TRAIL W

It sits on **Asa silty clay loam**, the better of the two soils and genuinely good garden ground; its best building spot is at **28.8 ft**, the highest in the portfolio, so it needs a lift of **eight inches** where the others need three to five feet; and it is the **cheapest lot at \$45,000**.

Getting Lot 2 to build-ready — land, pad, septic and foundation — costs about **\$65,000**. The same exercise is **\$109,000 on Lot 3**, **\$131,000 on Lot 1** and **\$139,000 on Lot 4**. What you give up is room: 1.00 acre of record, 187 ft wide, and the shortest water frontage of the four.

THIS IS A CHANGE FROM THE PREVIOUS EDITION, AND HERE IS WHY

v3.0 recommended Lot 1 on space and soil. Calculating the pad properly (\$20) rather than carrying a generic \$12k–\$45k range put a **\$66,000 gap** between the two on cost-to-build-ready. Lot 1 remains the better lot to *live* on — 1.95 acres and bayou frontage against 1.00 acre and a pond corner. The question is now explicit: **is the extra 0.95 acre and the bayou worth about \$66,000 to you?** If yes, buy Lot 1 and this document supports it. If you hesitate, buy Lot 2.

Scored against your brief. Soil from USDA SSURGO; ground and fill from a DEM grid inside each boundary (\$20).

RANK	LOT	GARDEN SOIL	ROOM	SCENERY	FLOOD HEADROOM	BUILD RISK	PRICE
1	336 Wagon Wheel Trl W 1.00 ac · PID 183367	Asa loam — well drained, prime	1.00 ac (0.87 by polygon)	Short frontage on a 12.6 ac pond	28.8 ft — 0.7 ft of fill	Low shrink-swell	\$45,000
2	1127 Saddle Horn Bend 1.95 ac · PID 183667	Asa loam — well drained, prime	1.95 ac	Mill Bayou, ~half the perimeter	25.3 ft — 4.2 ft of fill	Low shrink-swell	\$82,500
3	Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trl 1.30 ac · PID 186219	Pledger clay — 70% clay	1.30 ac	Good frontage, 12.6 ac pond	26.5 ft — 3.0 ft of fill	Vertisol — high movement	\$49,000
4	750 Wagon Wheel Trl 1.00 ac · PID 183332	Pledger clay — 73% clay	1.00 ac	Flag Lake, 101 acres	24.3 ft — up to 5.2 ft of fill	Vertisol + abuts a dam	\$58,000

WHY THE CHEAPEST LAND IS NOT THE ANSWER FOR YOU

On price alone Lot 29 wins outright — \$37,692 an acre and the only lot asking *below* the county's appraisal. This edition would recommend it to an investor.

But it sits on **Pledger clay**: 70% clay, a permeability of 0.21 µm/s, hydrologic group D, and a linear extensibility of **19** — a shrink-swell vertisol. That is the ground that cracks slabs, forces an aerobic septic system, ponds after rain and gardens only in a two-week moisture window. The \$10,000 you save on land you give back on the septic and the foundation, and you garden on it for the next thirty years. See §13.

THE CASE FOR PAYING UP FOR LOT 1

You garden. Lot 1 is **1.95 acres** against Lot 2's 1.00, on the same excellent Asa loam, with mature trees and roughly half its perimeter on Mill Bayou. That is the difference between a vegetable plot and an orchard, and it is the one thing on this list you cannot buy later.

The bill for that: **\$37,500 more land and about \$28,000 more pad**. It is also the closest of the four to State Highway 35, at 480 ft, though 1.95 treed acres absorb a good deal of that.

AND DO NOT BUY ALL FOUR

Four vacant lots cost **\$4,650–\$5,520 a year** to hold and return nothing — \$14,000–\$16,500 over a three-year window, on a portfolio already asking 15.6% above the county's appraised value. The build needs one lot; the other three add carry, not capability.

2 · Portfolio snapshot

LAND, ALL FOUR LOTS

\$234,500

5.25 ac of record **WAS “~4.95”**

COUNTY APPRAISED VALUE

\$202,900

asking a +15.6% premium

VERIFIED

ALL-IN, ONE LOT BUILT

\$505k–980k

land + site + 5BR house

ESTIMATE

ANNUAL CARRY, FOUR VACANT LOTS

\$4.7–5.5k

tax + POA + mowing

RATES CORRECTED

SITE FACTS THAT NOW HOLD FOR ALL FOUR LOTS — CHECKED PARCEL BY PARCEL

FEMA FIRM panel **48039C0420K**, effective **30 December 2020** **CORRECTED FROM 48039C0605K** · all four mapped **Zone AE**, SFHA = true, with **no static BFE** on the polygon (the BFE varies and must be read from the profile) **VERIFIED** · nearest published BFE line **28 ft NAVD88** at every lot **NEW** · finished floor required at **BFE + 24 in** **VERIFIED** · school district **Columbia-Brazoria ISD** for all four **VERIFIED** · **no** hospital district, **no** junior-college district, **no** MUD, **no** city limits **NEW** · water and sewer are **private well plus on-site septic** · **no** natural gas · TDI windstorm zone **Inland I, 120 mph** **NEW**.

THE SHAPE OF THE MONEY

Land, one lot	\$45k–82.5k
Pre-construction / site works	\$26k–108k
The house itself, 2,400–2,800 sq ft	\$420k–700k
Insurance, first year once built	\$5k–9.5k
Annual carry while vacant, x4	\$4.7k–5.5k

Land is **9–16%** of the all-in cost of putting a family into a house here. That is the single most important proportion in this document: the lot choice matters far less to the budget than the soil class, the pad and the distance to power — and all three of those are lot-specific unknowns that a \$600 soil test and three phone calls would resolve.

COSTS THE ORIGINAL PORTFOLIO OMITTED ENTIRELY

- The house — \$420,000 to \$700,000
- The septic system itself — \$8,000 to \$25,000
- Windstorm insurance — TWIA average \$2,541/yr
- Property tax — the largest carry line
- Electric service extension — up to \$25,000
- Engineered pad and fill — now **certain**, not optional (\$10)
- Propane, water treatment, culvert, clearing

COSTS THIS EDITION REMOVES

- **Angleton-Danbury Hospital District tax** — the lots are in no hospital district at all, so 0.074685 per \$100 comes out of the model
- **Angleton Drainage District tax** — the lots sit in county-wide drainage, not the Angleton district, so 0.052816 per \$100 comes out too
- **Brazosport / Alvin junior-college tax** — neither district reaches these parcels

Together those three lines were overstating the annual tax by roughly \$260–\$300 on the portfolio.

3 · The parcel record — established for the first time

Neither earlier edition contained a single parcel identifier. Every lot is now tied to its Brazoria County Appraisal District record. This is the table that resolves the acreage disputes, the section numbers and the value question.

Brazoria County ArcGIS, general/Parcels/MapServer/1 (BCAD parcel data), retrieved 11 September 2026. NEW IN V3

LISTING NAME	PID / GEO ID	LEGAL DESCRIPTION OF RECORD	ACRES OF RECORD	GIS POLYGON	BOUNDING BOX (FT)	BCAD APPRAISED	DEED
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	183667 1534-0084-000	Bar X Ranch SEC 2 BLK 1 LOT 84 ACRES 1.95	1.95	2.000	316 × 460	\$65,030	2008-031507
336 Wagon Wheel Trail W	183367 1533-0167-000	Bar X Ranch LOT 167 ACRES 1.	1.00	0.872	424 × 187	\$36,000	V1523P212
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trail	186219 1549-0029-000	Bar X Ranch SEC 16 BLK 1 LOT 29 ACRES 1.3	1.30	1.166	370 × 354	\$51,870	V268P248
750 Wagon Wheel Trail	183332 1533-0132-000	Bar X Ranch LOT 132 ACRES 1.	1.00	0.955	479 × 123	\$50,000	V1729P804

THIRTEEN OPEN ITEMS CLOSED

Parcel IDs and geo IDs for all four · legal descriptions · acreage of record for Lots 3 and 4 · the section number for Lots 2 and 4 · the recorded plat and restriction instrument for each section · the FIRM panel · the flood zone per parcel · the taxing districts · the school district · the jurisdiction · natural ground elevation · whether Lot 3 is waterfront · whether Lot 4 is 1.0 or 1.27 acres.

WHERE THE ACREAGE CLAIMS LANDED

LOT	EARLIER EDITIONS SAID	COUNTY RECORD SAYS	EFFECT
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	1.95 ac	1.95 ac — confirmed	None. The one acreage that was right.
336 Wagon Wheel Trl W	1.00 ac	1.00 ac of record, but the county polygon computes to 0.872 ac	Buildable area may be ~13% less than the deed implies. Survey it.
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trl	1.0 ac "est."	1.30 ac	\$/acre falls from ~\$49,000 to \$37,692 . Best value in the portfolio.
750 Wagon Wheel Trl	1.0 ac or 1.27 ac — unresolved	1.00 ac. The 1.27 figure is wrong.	Confirms it as the dearest land per acre, by 28% over Lot 29.

TWO PER-LOT DIFFERENCES NOBODY HAD NOTICED

- **The four lots are not governed by one set of deed restrictions.** Lots 2 and 4 are in Bar-X Ranch Section 1 (plat 16/104, restrictions 1515/679, 1980, plus drainage easements 1712/500); Lot 1 is Section 2 (plat 16/119, restrictions 1532/471, 1980); Lot 3 is Section 16 (plat 17/219, restrictions 84-29/885, **1984**). Three different recorded instruments, so the "ACC Rev 2" quoted as a single controlling document across all four lots cannot be right. The minimum-square-footage and garage rules must be read per section.
- **Lot 2 alone sits inside the Baileys Prairie extraterritorial jurisdiction.** Baileys Prairie subdivision regulation reaches it; the other three answer only to the county.

Owner-of-record names are in the BCAD record and are deliberately not reproduced here. Search by PID at esearch.brazoriacad.org.

4 · Value — asking price against the county's own number

Pricing land per acre only works once the acreage is right, which is why neither earlier edition could do it. With the acreage of record established, two independent value tests are available: price per acre, and price against the appraisal the county already publishes for each parcel.

Asking prices from listing copy UNVERIFIED; acreage and appraised value from the BCAD parcel record VERIFIED

LOT	ASKING	ACRES OF RECORD	\$ PER ACRE	BCAD APPRAISED	PREMIUM	PREMIUM \$
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	\$82,500	1.95 ac	\$42,308	\$65,030	+26.9%	\$17,470
336 Wagon Wheel Trail W	\$45,000	1.00 ac	\$45,000	\$36,000	+25.0%	\$9,000
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trail	\$49,000	1.30 ac	\$37,692	\$51,870	-5.5%	\$-2,870
750 Wagon Wheel Trail	\$58,000	1.00 ac	\$58,000	\$50,000	+16.0%	\$8,000
Portfolio	\$234,500	5.25 ac	\$44,667	\$202,900	+15.6%	\$31,600

PRICE PER ACRE, RE-RANKED

Lot 29 Broken Arrow	\$37,692
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	\$42,308
336 Wagon Wheel Trl W	\$45,000
750 Wagon Wheel Trl	\$58,000

The second edition ranked 1127 Saddle Horn Bend cheapest per acre. Correcting Lot 29 from an estimated 1.0 acre to its recorded 1.30 acres moves it to the front by 11%.

PREMIUM OVER COUNTY APPRAISAL

Lot 29 Broken Arrow	-5.5%
750 Wagon Wheel Trl	+16.0%
336 Wagon Wheel Trl W	+25.0%
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	+26.9%

An appraisal is not a market value, and Texas appraisals commonly lag a rising market. But a **27% premium** on one lot and a **discount** on another, inside the same subdivision and the same flood zone, is a negotiating fact.

HOW TO USE THIS AT THE NEGOTIATING TABLE

The four appraised values total **\$202,900** against a \$234,500 ask. The county's appraisal is the number the seller pays tax on and the number that will be quoted back at them. On Lots 1, 2 and 4 there is a documented \$31,600 of daylight to argue about. On Lot 29 there is none — the seller is already under the county's number, which is a further reason to treat it as the pick rather than to push it.

A CAUTION ON THE POLYGON ACREAGES

The GIS polygon area computed from the county's own parcel geometry runs **3–13% below** the acreage of record on three of the four lots (Lot 1 is the exception, computing slightly above). Appraisal-district polygons are maintained for mapping, not for conveyancing, and the county says so. Do not treat either figure as survey-grade — but do notice that on Lot 2 the gap is large enough to matter to a septic layout on a 1-acre lot.

5 · All four lots on one interactive map

The map below is live Google Maps satellite imagery with all four parcels pinned in order. Use the buttons to switch between the four-lot route view, the whole subdivision, and each lot individually. Below it, the same four parcels are drawn as their **actual county boundary polygons** — which is what shows you where the water frontage really is.

Combined Google Maps satellite view of all four lots. Interactive in the browser version. The four parcel centroids are tabulated below; each is a live link.

THE SAME FOUR PARCELS AS RECORDED BOUNDARIES

Parcel centroids, WGS 84

LOT	LISTING NAME	LATITUDE	LONGITUDE	PID	OPEN LIVE
1	1127 Saddle Horn Bend	29.141219	-95.559141	183667	Google Maps · Street View
2	336 Wagon Wheel Trail W	29.140524	-95.541472	183367	Google Maps · Street View
3	Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trail	29.144419	-95.543456	186219	Google Maps · Street View
4	750 Wagon Wheel Trail	29.130575	-95.541987	183332	Google Maps · Street View

1127 Saddle Horn Bend

Angleton, TX 77515 • Bar-X Ranch #2 • Block 1, Lot 84

ZONE AE WATERFRONT — MILL BAYOU LARGEST — 1.95 AC

\$82,500

\$42,308 per acre • 1.95 ac of record
+26.9% vs county appraisal



LEGAL	Block 1, Lot 84 • 1.95 ac of record	GROUND (LIDAR)	24–25 ft at the parcel
SITUS OF RECORD	1127 SADDLE HORN BEND	SOIL	Asa silty clay loam — well drained, prime farmland
DEED • PLAT • RESTRICTIONS	2008-031507 • 16/119 • 1532/471	WATER	Mill Bayou — a tree-lined stream corridor. Nearest mapped waterbody 395 ft.
DIMENSIONS	bbox 316 × 460 ft • county polygon 2.000 ac	HIGHWAY	0.09 mi (about 480 ft) south of State Highway 35
FLOOD	Zone AE • panel 48039C0420K, 30 Dec 2020	JURISDICTION	Unincorporated • no city limits or ETJ
NEAREST BFE LINE	28.0 ft NAVD88 , 1,594 ft off the parcel		



[Open in Google Maps](#) [Google Street View](#) [Zillow — search this address](#) [BCAD record — PID 183667](#) [LoopNet listing](#)

BEST FOR Setback geometry. The extra acre is the only thing on offer here that actually solves the 5BR + drainfield + 100% reserve + well-spacing puzzle comfortably.	WATCH Longest water frontage means the largest share of the lot is in the low ground near the channel, and the TCEQ 75 ft absorption setback bites along all of it. It also sits downstream of Bar X Development Dam (NID TX01759) on a Mill Bayou tributary.
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VERDICT ON THIS LOT
Buy this one if the plan is a large house and you will pay for the pad.

336 Wagon Wheel Trail W

Angleton, TX 77515 • Bar-X Ranch #1 • Lot 167

ZONE AE WATERFRONT LOWEST PRICE BAILEYS PRAIRIE ETJ

\$45,000

\$45,000 per acre • 1.00 ac of record
+25.0% vs county appraisal



LEGAL	Lot 167 • 1.00 ac of record	GROUND (LIDAR)	28 ft at the parcel
SITUS OF RECORD	336 WAGON WHEEL TRAIL	SOIL	Asa silty clay loam — well drained, prime farmland
DEED • PLAT • RESTRICTIONS	V1523P212 • 16/104 • 1515/679	WATER	Unnamed 12.6-acre pond , 41 ft off the boundary. Shortest frontage of the four.
DIMENSIONS	bbox 424 × 187 ft • county polygon 0.872 ac	HIGHWAY	0.37 mi south of State Highway 35
FLOOD	Zone AE • panel 48039C0420K, 30 Dec 2020	JURISDICTION	Unincorporated • Baileys Prairie ETJ
NEAREST BFE LINE	28.0 ft NAVD88 , 1,010 ft off the parcel		



Open in Google Maps Google Street View Zillow — search this address BCAD record — PID 183367

BEST FOR

Lowest cash outlay, and the highest natural ground of the four at 28 ft — which is the single most valuable physical attribute in a Zone AE subdivision.

WATCH

The shape is the problem: 424 ft × 187 ft on 1.00 acre of record, and the county's own polygon computes to 0.872 acre. Fitting a 5BR footprint, a 2,250–4,500 sq ft spray field, a 100% reserve area and a well at 100 ft from the field on a 187 ft width is the tightest test in the portfolio. This is also the only lot inside the Baileys Prairie ETJ, so Baileys Prairie subdivision regulation reaches it.

VERDICT ON THIS LOT

Cheapest entry and the best ground, but prove the footprint fits before you bid.

Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trail

Angleton, TX 77515 • Bar-X Ranch #16 • Block 1, Lot 29

ZONE AE WATERFRONT — RECLASSIFIED BEST VALUE 1.30 AC

\$49,000

\$37,692 per acre • 1.30 ac of record
-5.5% vs county appraisal



LEGAL	Block 1, Lot 29 • 1.30 ac of record	GROUND (LIDAR)	26 ft at the parcel (a 26 ft contour runs 3 ft from the centroid)
SITUS OF RECORD	HIGHWAY 35	SOIL	Pledger clay — vertisol, hydrologic group D
DEED • PLAT • RESTRICTIONS	V268P248 • 17/219 • 84-29/885	WATER	The same 12.6-acre pond as Lot 2, 59 ft off, with about twice the frontage.
DIMENSIONS	bbox 370 × 354 ft • county polygon 1.166 ac	HIGHWAY	0.10 mi (about 530 ft) south of State Highway 35
FLOOD	Zone AE • panel 48039C0420K, 30 Dec 2020	JURISDICTION	Unincorporated • no city limits or ETJ
NEAREST BFE LINE	28.0 ft NAVD88 , 2,477 ft off the parcel		



Open in Google Maps Google Street View Zillow — search this address BCAD record — PID 186219

BEST FOR

Value, on every measure that can be checked. It is the only lot priced below the county's own appraisal, the cheapest per acre by 11%, the second largest, and it is waterfront after all.

WATCH

Section 16 is governed by a different recorded restriction instrument (84-29/885, 1984) from Sections 1 and 2, so the ACC rules are not necessarily the same ones quoted for the other lots. No street number has been assigned, so confirm the listing actually refers to PID 186219.

VERDICT ON THIS LOT

On the verified record this is the pick of the four. Confirm the identity first.

750 Wagon Wheel Trail

Angleton, TX 77515 • Bar-X Ranch #1 • Lot 132

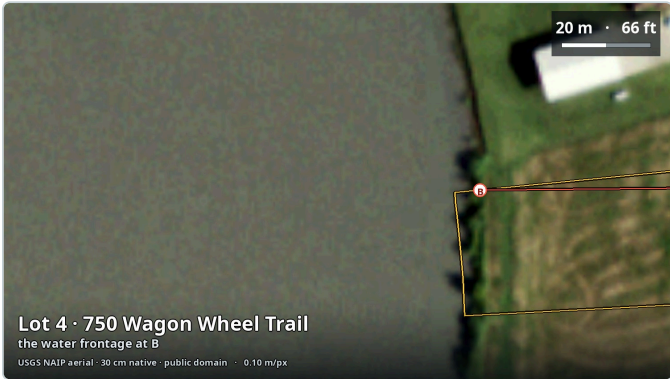
ZONE AE WATERFRONT — FLAG LAKE ABUTS A DAM DEAREST / ACRE

\$58,000

\$58,000 per acre • 1.00 ac of record
+16.0% vs county appraisal



LEGAL	Lot 132 • 1.00 ac of record	GROUND (LIDAR)	24 ft at the parcel (a 24 ft contour passes within 1 ft of the centroid)
SITUS OF RECORD	750 WAGON WHEEL TRAIL	SOIL	Pledger clay — vertisol, hydrologic group D
DEED • PLAT • RESTRICTIONS	V1729P804 • 16/104 • 1515/679	WATER	Flag Pond, 101.5 ac — named in USGS hydrography 14 ft off, plus the levee.
DIMENSIONS	bbox 479 × 123 ft • county polygon 0.955 ac	HIGHWAY	1.03 mi south of State Highway 35
FLOOD	Zone AE • panel 48039C0420K, 30 Dec 2020	JURISDICTION	Unincorporated • no city limits or ETJ
NEAREST BFE LINE	28.0 ft NAVD88 , 1,492 ft off the parcel		



Open in Google Maps Google Street View Zillow — search this address BCAD record — PID 183332 Realtor.com listing

BEST FOR

The view and the water. If the point of the exercise is a lake house, this is the only lot that delivers a 101-acre lake rather than a 13-acre pond.

WATCH

Two things. It is 1.00 acre of record — **not** the 1.27 acres quoted from LoopNet — which makes it the most expensive land per acre in the portfolio by 28% over Lot 3. And the boundary is 11 ft from a levee embankment that impounds a 101-acre lake; the National Inventory of Dams carries no hazard-potential classification and no condition rating for it.

VERDICT ON THIS LOT

Best lot to live on, worst lot to buy on price. The dam needs answering first.

10 · Flood — the finding that changes the build

All four lots are in a mapped Special Flood Hazard Area. That was never in doubt. What both earlier editions got wrong is the elevation arithmetic, and it goes the wrong way.

THE CORRECTION

Both earlier editions assumed a base flood elevation of **24 ft** and concluded that natural ground of 28–30 ft cleared the county's requirement comfortably, so the house could be built at grade with no fill. Queried against the county's own copy of the effective FIRM:

- The **nearest published BFE line to every one of the four lots reads 28 ft NAVD88**, with a 29 ft line further upstream. Not 24 ft.
- The Zone AE polygon carries **no static BFE** — meaning the BFE varies across it and must be read from the flood profile, which is precisely why a single assumed figure was never safe.
- County **LiDAR elevation contours** put natural ground at the parcels at **24–28 ft**, not 28–30 ft.

Per-lot elevation arithmetic at the **optimum pad location** on each lot, from a 5 m DEM grid inside each boundary. Requirement = 28 ft BFE + 24 in freeboard = 30 ft. Costed in \$20. **NEW IN V3**

LOT	NEAREST PUBLISHED BFE	GROUND AT PARCEL (LIDAR)	REQUIRED FINISHED FLOOR	FILL / STEM WALL NEEDED	CONSEQUENCE
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	28 ft	25.3 ft	30 ft	4.2 ft	1,416 cy of fill. Room to build the pad and its slopes easily.
336 Wagon Wheel Trl W	28 ft	28.8 ft	30 ft	0.7 ft	268 cy. Practically at grade — the standout of the four.
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trl	28 ft	26.5 ft	30 ft	3.0 ft	963 cy. Straightforward.
750 Wagon Wheel Trl	28 ft	24.3–25.7 ft	30 ft	3.8–5.2 ft	1,255–1,808 cy, and the pad barely fits the width. See \$20.

WHAT THIS DOES TO THE COST MODEL

The second edition carried engineered pad and fill at **\$0–\$8,000**, treating it as optional. On these figures it is not optional on any lot, and a 4–6 ft lift under a 2,400–2,800 sq ft house is a different item altogether.

\$20 prices this per lot: \$12,400 to \$77,800. It is the third largest line in the whole project after the house and the land.

It also all but forecloses the LOMA. A Letter of Map Amendment requires naturally high ground; placing fill converts the application into a LOMR-F, which carries a FEMA review fee and a far heavier evidential burden.

750 WAGON WHEEL TRAIL SITS AGAINST A DAM

The parcel boundary runs **11 ft** from the **Flag Lake Levee** embankment, which impounds the 101.5-acre Flag Pond. The structure is in the National Inventory of Dams as **TX06298**. Published NID data carries **no hazard-potential classification and no condition assessment** for it.

Lot 1 has a lighter version of the same question: it lies downstream of **Bar X Development Dam (NID TX01759)** on a Mill Bayou tributary, which NID does rate — low hazard potential. Ask TCEQ Dam Safety about both before buying either.

WHAT STILL HAS TO BE CONFIRMED IN WRITING, PER LOT

- **The site-specific BFE** from Brazoria County Floodplain & 911 Administration. A published BFE line 1,000–2,500 ft away is strong evidence, not a determination. Ask which cross-section governs each lot — Mill Bayou governs Lot 1, and it is a different watercourse from the one governing Lots 2 and 3.
- **Lowest adjacent grade at the proposed footprint**, from a topographic survey. The LiDAR contour band is a screening tool; the elevation certificate will be written from a survey.
- **Pluvial ponding**. Flat coastal clay floods from rainfall alone, and a riverine BFE says nothing about it. The wettest year in the 1991–2020 record delivered **2,024 mm** of rain against a 1,177 mm average — four times the driest year.
- **Levee status**. Whether the Angleton Levee is FEMA-accredited, and its trajectory, remains unconfirmed — as does the condition of Flag Lake Levee.

One correction carried forward: the county's 24-inch freeboard was adopted by Commissioners Court in **May 2005**, not raised after Hurricane Harvey in 2017. The original portfolio's causal story was twelve years out.

11 • Terrain, slope and how the drawings were made

The next four pages give each lot a true-scale plan with the county's 1-foot LiDAR contours, and a longitudinal section cut along the dotted A-B line from the roadside boundary to the lakeside boundary.

HOW TO READ THEM

- **The plan is rotated** so that A-B runs left to right. North is shown by the needle, which therefore points somewhere other than up.
- **Plan and section share the same horizontal scale** and the same left-right position, so you can drop a finger down from any point on the plan to the same point on the section.
- **A** is the boundary at the street, **B** the boundary at the water. The profile is continued a short way past both so the road ditch and the water are visible.
- **The section is drawn three times.** Once vertically exaggerated so the shape can be seen, with the **true** slope angles printed on the notable breaks; once at a true **1:1**, which is what the ground really looks like; and once as an earth-curvature check.

WHERE THE ELEVATIONS COME FROM

Contours are Brazoria County's published LiDAR product at a **1-foot interval**. The profile is sampled from the **USGS 3DEP 1-metre digital elevation model** at roughly 1 m spacing along the line, converted from metres to feet. The two are independent datasets and they agree to within about a foot across all four lots, which is the main reason to trust either.

HONEST LIMITATION

A DEM is a model of a bare-earth surface, not a survey. Slope angles quoted over a 6–8 m baseline are reliable to a fraction of a degree; spot elevations are good to roughly ±0.5 ft. An elevation certificate will be written from an instrument survey, not from this.

THE FOUR LOTS COMPARED ON TERRAIN

Plateau figures are the range across the level central part of each transect — the part you would actually build on. **NEW IN V3**

LOT	SECTION A-B	GROUND ON THE BUILDABLE PLATEAU	HIGHEST	LOWEST	RELIEF	STEEPEST BANK	FILL AT THE BEST PAD (\$20)
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	562 ft	24–26 ft	26.0 ft	21.2 ft	4.8 ft	8.4° (15%)	4.2 ft
336 Wagon Wheel Trl W	412 ft	27–29 ft	29.1 ft	21.2 ft	8.0 ft	8.8° (16%)	0.7 ft
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trl	453 ft	26–27 ft	26.9 ft	21.2 ft	5.7 ft	11.6° (20%)	3.0 ft
750 Wagon Wheel Trl	568 ft	23–24 ft	30.7 ft (levee crest)	23.1 ft	7.6 ft	8.5° (15%)	3.8–5.2 ft

THE HEADLINE: THIS IS FLAT LAND WITH A BANK AT THE END

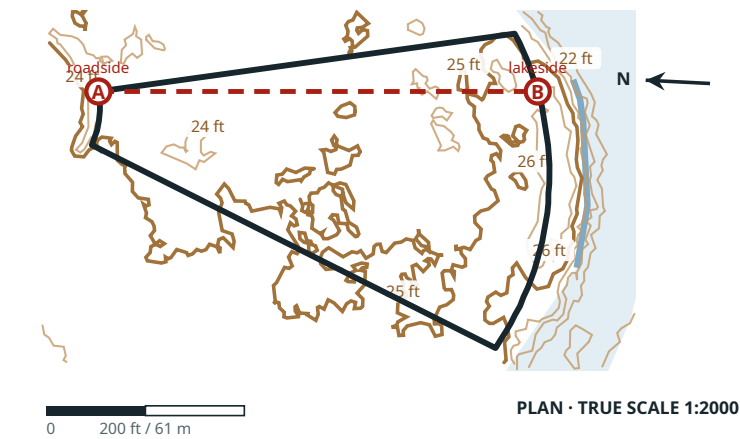
Across all four lots the buildable ground falls within about **1.5 ft over 300–400 ft** — a true gradient of roughly **0.2°**, which is why the 1:1 panels look like straight lines. That is *good* news for a garden and for a house pad, and *bad* news for drainage: water does not run off flat clay, it sits on it. Every angle worth reporting is concentrated in the last few metres before the water, where the bank drops 3–4 ft at 8–12°, and in the roadside ditch.

ON EARTH CURVATURE, SINCE YOU ASKED

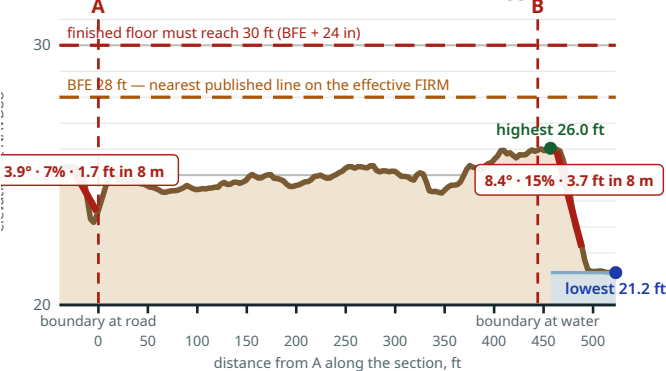
Each section carries a curvature panel. Over transects of 412–568 ft the sea-level surface departs from the flat drawing datum by **1.5 to 2.4 mm** — that is 0.005 to 0.008 *feet*, roughly one hundredth of the DEM's own vertical uncertainty and about one two-hundredth of a single contour interval. It is drawn, exaggerated by a factor of tens of thousands, purely so you can see that it has been checked. It is correctly ignored everywhere else in this document.

12 · Terrain — Lot 1, 1127 Saddle Horn Bend

Plan and section at a true horizontal scale of 1:2000. Contours are the county's 1 ft LiDAR product; the profile is USGS 3DEP 1 m DEM. Section A-B runs from the Saddle Horn Bend frontage (A) to the water boundary (B), a distance of **444 ft** across the parcel.



SECTION A-B horizontal 1:2000 true · vertical ×26 exaggerated so the shape is visible



THE SAME GROUND AT 1:1 no vertical exaggeration — this is the real shape of the



EARTH-CURVATURE CHECK over the 562 ft section, against the flat datum used at flat chord — the datum every panel above uses

true curved sea-level surface: it falls away by just **2.31 mm (0.0076 ft)** at mid-section
this panel is exaggerated ×29,882 vertically just to make the curve visible

WHAT THE GROUND DOES

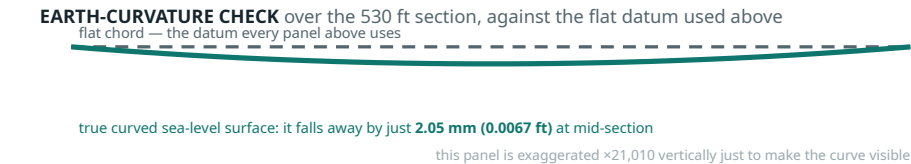
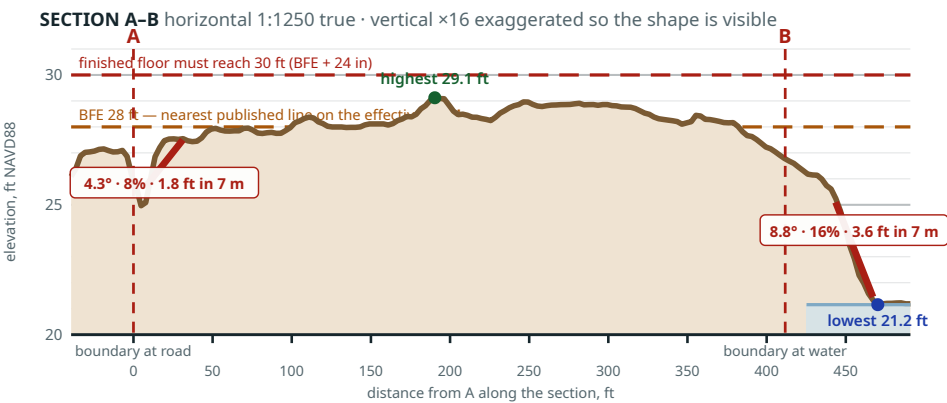
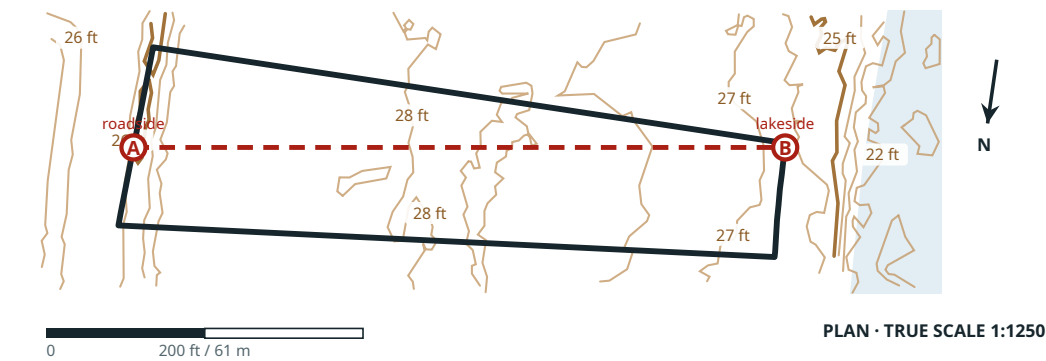
The section runs 562 ft from the Saddle Horn Bend frontage out to the Mill Bayou edge. The lot is a wedge: narrow at the road, wide at the water. Ground sits at 24–26 ft across the buildable middle, then drops **3.7 ft in the last 8 m** to the bayou at 21.2 ft — an **8.4° bank**. There is a second, sharper dip right at the road: 1.7 ft in 8 m at 3.9°, which is the roadside drainage ditch, not landform. Everything between is within a foot and a half of level.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR BUILDING

The pad problem is visible here. The highest natural point anywhere on the transect is 26.0 ft, and the finished floor has to reach 30 ft. That is a **4 ft lift at the very best spot**, and 5–6 ft anywhere you would actually want to sit the house.

13 · Terrain — Lot 2, 336 Wagon Wheel Trail W

Plan and section at a true horizontal scale of 1:1250. Contours are the county's 1 ft LiDAR product; the profile is USGS 3DEP 1 m DEM. Section A-B runs from the Wagon Wheel Trl frontage (A) to the water boundary (B), a distance of 412 ft across the parcel.



WHAT THE GROUND DOES

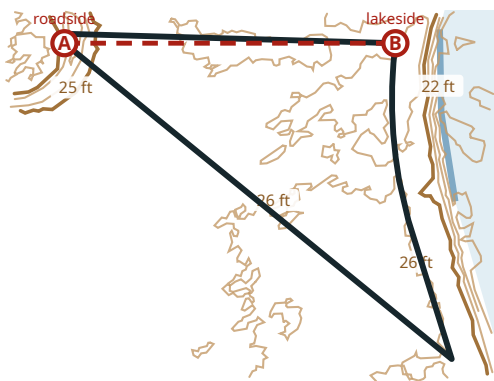
The section runs 412 ft from Wagon Wheel Trail to the pond. This is the driest profile of the four: the ground rises off the road to **29.1 ft** — the highest natural elevation measured on any of the four lots — holds a broad, genuinely level plateau across the middle of the lot, then falls away at **8.8°** over the last few metres to the water at 21.2 ft.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR BUILDING

At 29.1 ft the plateau is **within a foot of the 30 ft requirement**. That is the single most valuable physical fact in this portfolio: a foot of fill instead of five or six, on a lot that also happens to be the cheapest.

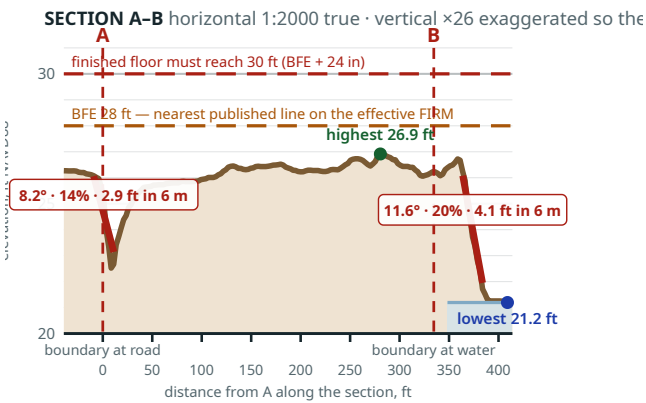
14 • Terrain — Lot 3, Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trail

Plan and section at a true horizontal scale of 1:2000. Contours are the county's 1 ft LiDAR product; the profile is USGS 3DEP 1 m DEM. Section A-B runs from the Broken Arrow Trl frontage (A) to the water boundary (B), a distance of 335 ft across the parcel.



0 150 ft / 46 m

PLAN • TRUE SCALE 1:2000



EARTH-CURVATURE CHECK over the 453 ft section, against the flat datum — the datum every panel above uses

true curved sea-level surface: it falls away by just 1.50 mm (0.0049 ft) at mid-sector
this panel is exaggerated ×45,958 vertically just to make the curve visible

WHAT THE GROUND DOES

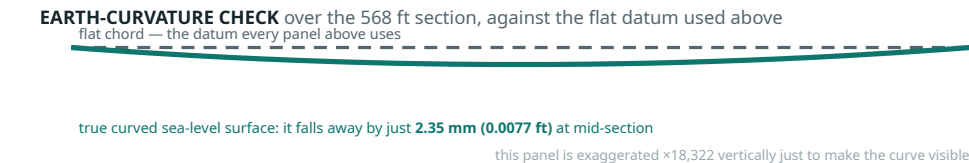
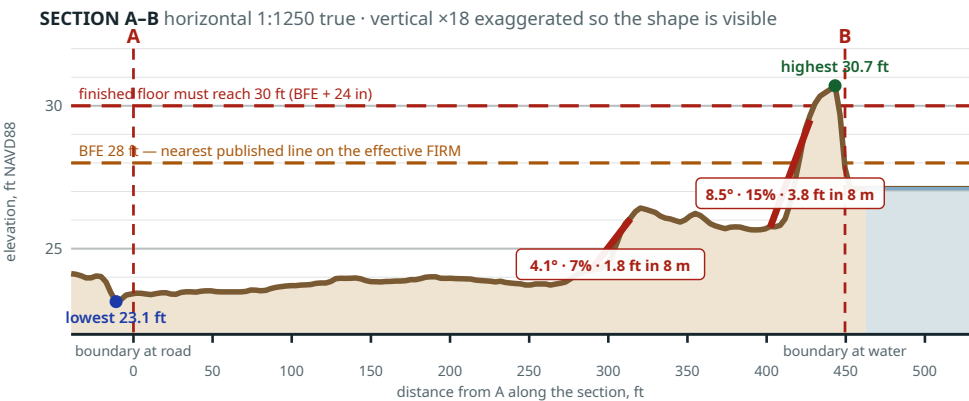
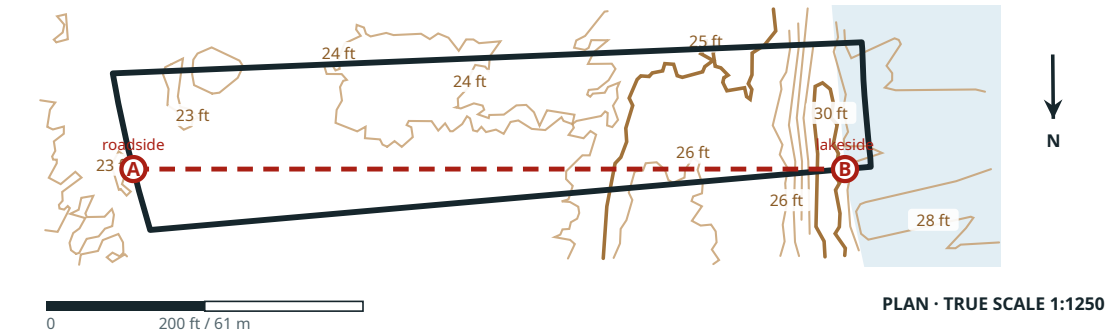
The section runs 453 ft from Broken Arrow Trail to the pond. The plateau is real and broad at 26–27 ft, with the high point at 26.9 ft. The lakeside bank is the **steepest of the four at 11.6°** — 4.1 ft of drop in 6 m — and there is another 8.2° cut at the road, again the ditch.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR BUILDING

Good, level building ground at 26–27 ft, needing about 3–4 ft of fill. The steep bank at B matters for the TCEQ 75 ft absorption setback and for erosion, and the ground it is cut into is Pledger clay.

15 • Terrain — Lot 4, 750 Wagon Wheel Trail

Plan and section at a true horizontal scale of 1:1250. Contours are the county's 1 ft LiDAR product; the profile is USGS 3DEP 1 m DEM. Section A-B runs from the Wagon Wheel Trl frontage (A) to the water boundary (B), a distance of 450 ft across the parcel.



WHAT THE GROUND DOES

The section runs 568 ft from Wagon Wheel Trail to Flag Pond, and it is the one profile that behaves backwards: the ground **rises** toward the water, from 23.1 ft near the road to **30.7 ft** at the far boundary, on a sustained **8.5°** climb.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR BUILDING

That rise is not a hill. It is the **Flag Lake Levee embankment**. The 101-acre pond is impounded *above* the level of the buildable part of the lot — the interior sits at 23–24 ft, the lowest of the four, while the crest beside it reaches 30.7 ft. You would be building in the shadow of a structure the National Inventory of Dams carries with no hazard classification and no condition rating.

16 · Soil — the one thing that decides all three of your problems

Soil settles your garden, your septic system and your foundation at the same time, and the four lots do not share it. The USDA soil survey splits them cleanly down the middle.

USDA NRCS SSURGO, Brazoria County soil survey, major component of the map unit at each parcel centroid. NEW IN V3

PROPERTY	LOTS 1 & 2 — ASA SILTY CLAY LOAM	LOTS 3 & 4 — PLEDGER CLAY	WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU
Taxonomy	Fluventic Hapludoll — an alluvial mollisol	Typic Hapludert — a vertisol	Mollisols are the world's good farming soils. Vertisols are fertile but physically hostile.
Clay content, topsoil	36.5%	69.5%	Workability, drainage, everything.
Organic matter, topsoil	3.1%	6.5%	Both genuinely fertile; Pledger more so.
pH (1:1 water)	6.8 — near neutral	7.0 — neutral	Both excellent. Neither needs correcting for most vegetables.
Drainage class	Well drained	Moderately well drained	Wet feet kill more garden plants here than cold does.
Surface runoff	Negligible	High	High runoff on flat ground means standing water after rain.
Hydrologic group	B	D	D is the worst class — least infiltration, most runoff. A pluvial flood risk the FEMA map does not describe.
Saturated conductivity	9.0 µm/s	0.21 µm/s	Pledger is 43× less permeable . This is what drives the septic system type.
Linear extensibility (shrink-swell)	4.5 — low to moderate	19 — very high	Above about 9 is "high". This is the number that cracks slabs, drives, and pipework.
Available water capacity	0.18–0.20	0.14	Asa holds more plant-available water despite being lighter.
Farmland classification	All areas prime farmland	All areas prime farmland	Both are officially prime. "Prime" is about fertility, not about being easy.
Flooding frequency	Rarely flooded	Rarely flooded	Same on both.

ASA SILTY CLAY LOAM — LOTS 1 AND 2

For gardening: this is the good stuff. A silty clay loam at pH 6.8 with 3% organic matter, well drained, negligible runoff. It works over a wide moisture range, takes a spade in most weather, holds water without waterlogging, and needs no pH correction. You could plant directly into it.

For septic: at 9 µm/s it is likely TCEQ **Class III**, which means roughly 2,250 sq ft of absorptive area and a realistic chance of avoiding a full aerobic spray system. **For foundations:** a linear extensibility of 4.5 is ordinary engineering.

PLEDGER CLAY — LOTS 3 AND 4

For gardening: hard work, permanently. Nearly 70% clay with slickensides in the subsoil. It is sticky and unworkable when wet, sets like fired brick when dry, and opens cracks you can put a hand into in August. Very fertile — but most people here end up gardening in **raised beds with imported soil**, which is a real annual cost and effort.

For septic: 0.21 µm/s is effectively impermeable — TCEQ **Class IV**, a conventional drainfield is not allowed, and an **aerobic unit with a spray or drip field is mandatory**: \$15,000–\$25,000 plus a maintenance contract for life. **For foundations:** extensibility 19 demands a post-tensioned or pier-and-beam design plus lifelong moisture management around the perimeter.

WHAT THIS IS WORTH, IN MONEY

On the septic alone the soil difference is plausibly **\$7,000–\$15,000** in favour of Lots 1 and 2, plus \$300–\$600 a year forever for the aerobic maintenance contract that Lots 3 and 4 will require. On the foundation, a post-tensioned slab engineered for a high-PI vertisol typically runs **\$8,000–\$20,000** above a conventional engineered slab on a 2,400–2,800 sq ft house. Lot 29's \$10,000 land saving does not survive either comparison, let alone both.

THE LIMIT OF THIS FINDING — AND IT IS A REAL LIMIT

SSURGO is mapped at about 1:24,000. It tells you the soil that *predominates* in a map unit, and the major component here is given an 85% share. It is strong evidence and it is free; it is **not** a site-specific soil evaluation, and the TCEQ soil class that actually governs your permit can only be set by a licensed site evaluator digging on your lot. Order that evaluation on the shortlisted lot before you close. It costs \$350–\$600 and it is the highest-value money in this entire project.

17 • Deed restrictions and buildability

The recorded Bar X Ranch declaration of restrictions has now been read rather than paraphrased. Several figures repeated by the earlier editions are not in it, and several provisions that matter a great deal to your plans are.

Bar X Ranch declaration of restrictions as recorded (Deed Vol. 1679, Pg. 695). **NEW IN V3**

PROVISION	WHAT THE RECORDED INSTRUMENT ACTUALLY SAYS	EFFECT ON YOUR PLAN
§3.15 Pets and livestock	No livestock of any kind other than house pets of reasonable kind and number. Horses are the single express exception: 1 per 32,670 sq ft, 2 per 42,000 sq ft, one more per additional 21,880 sq ft.	Chickens and ducks are not house pets and are not horses. Your hobby-farming plan is very likely barred.
§3.01 Structures permitted	One single-family dwelling, one attached or detached garage, and one horse barn no larger than 30 ft × 25 ft. Anything else needs written committee approval before construction.	No coop, no run, no shed, no greenhouse without a written variance. A greenhouse is as much of an issue as a coop.
§3.03 Dwelling size	Minimum 1,100 sq ft of living area, excluding open porches and garages; 1,400 sq ft if more than two storeys.	The “ 1,800 sq ft minimum ” quoted by earlier editions is not in this instrument. Your 2,400–2,800 sq ft house clears it easily either way.
§3.06 Minimum lot area	No building on a lot under 21,880 sq ft; no resubdivision without written committee approval.	All four lots clear this. Lot 2 at 0.872 ac by the county polygon is still 38,000 sq ft.
§3.05 Orientation	The front of the lot is the property line with the shortest dimension abutting a street; the dwelling must face it; a detached garage may sit no nearer the front line than the house.	Fixes your house orientation. On the long, narrow lots this constrains where the septic field and garden can go.
§3.12 Fences	Any lot with a horse barn must be fenced. All fences and their locations need written approval. No home-made fences.	A garden fence — against deer, rabbits and your own dogs — is a committee submission.
§3.04 Roofing	Wood shingle, built-up tar and gravel, or asphalt shingle of not less than 340 lb per square.	Rules out standing-seam metal without a variance; metal is otherwise the sensible coastal choice.
§3.07 Nuisance	No noxious or offensive activity, nor anything that may become an annoyance to the neighbourhood. Exterior display or discharge of firearms expressly forbidden.	A cockerel is the textbook “annoyance” complaint even where hens are tolerated.
§3.13 Lot maintenance	Owners must keep grass and weeds cut and fences painted; the association may enter, do the work, and bill the owner.	This is the origin of the \$125 vacant-lot mowing charge in the carrying-cost model.
§3.14 / §3.16 Septic and drainage	No septic tank may drain into road ditches. Drainage of streets, lots or roadway ditches may not be impaired.	Directly relevant to the 2–6 ft pad that §10 shows you need: you may not solve your flood problem by pushing water onto the road or a neighbour.
§4.05 Committee	The architectural control committee's powers ceased 15 years after the instrument and passed to the property owners' association.	Submissions go to the POA today, not to a developer committee.

THE CAVEAT THAT YOU MUST CLOSE BEFORE RELYING ON ANY OF THIS

The instrument read above is **one** Bar X Ranch declaration. Your four lots are governed by **three different recorded instruments** — Section 1 by 1515/679 (1980), Section 2 by 1532/471 (1980), Section 16 by 84-29/885 (1984) — and none of them is the document quoted here. Subdivision declarations of this era were near-identical in form across sections, so the provisions above are very likely to be substantially what governs your lot. **Very likely is not good enough for the decision you are making.** Pull the recorded instrument for the specific lot from the Brazoria County Clerk, and ask the POA in writing, before you close, one question: *may I keep a small number of chickens and ducks, and may I build a coop and a greenhouse?* Get the answer on letterhead.

IF POULTRY IS THE POINT, HERE IS THE ALTERNATIVE

Unincorporated Brazoria County has **no zoning**, so outside a deed-restricted subdivision there is generally nothing stopping you keeping poultry on your own land. The trade is everything Bar X Ranch gives you — the two lakes, two pools, clubhouses, tennis and basketball courts, playgrounds, concrete streets, the 97% owner-occupied neighbourhood and the maintained frontages. Unrestricted acreage a few miles further out will let you keep ducks and will not give you any of that. That is the real choice in front of you, and it is not a choice this document can make for you.

18 · Septic (OSSF) — sized against the regulation, per soil

Every house here is on a private well and an on-site sewage facility. This is where the original portfolio was most wrong, and where §16's soil finding now produces two different answers.

30 TAC §295.91 Table III and §295.91(2)

BASIS	FLOW Q (GPD)	SEPTIC TANK REQUIRED
5 bedrooms, dwelling under 4,500 sq ft, no water-saving devices	450	Both flows fall in the 351–500 gpd band ▯ 1,250 gal minimum VERIFIED
Same, with water-saving devices	360	

Absorptive area = $Q \div R_a$. The original portfolio used 0.6 gal/sf/day, which exceeds every class in the TCEQ table. **VERIFIED**

TCEQ SOIL CLASS	LOADING RATE R_a	ABSORPTIVE AREA AT $Q = 450$	WHICH LOTS	SYSTEM THAT RESULTS
Class III — clay loam	0.20 gal/sf/day	~2,250 sq ft	Lots 1 & 2 — Asa, 9 μ m/s	Conventional drainfield may be permissible; low-pressure dosed or aerobic if not. \$8,000–\$15,000
Class IV — clay	0.10 gal/sf/day	~4,500 sq ft	Lots 3 & 4 — Pledger, 0.21 μ m/s	Conventional drainfield not permitted . Aerobic treatment unit (600 gal min) plus spray or drip field, and a mandatory maintenance contract. \$15,000–\$25,000
Class Ib–II — sandy/loamy	0.25–0.38	~1,184–1,800 sq ft	Neither, on the survey	Conventional. Cheapest outcome, not available here.

THE NUMBER THE ORIGINAL DOCUMENT SIMPLY DID NOT CONTAIN

Whichever class applies, TCEQ requires a **100% reserve area** in addition to the field. On Lots 3 and 4 that means committing roughly **9,000 sq ft — a fifth of a one-acre lot** — to sewage disposal, before the house, the driveway, the garage, the well and your garden. On Lots 1 and 2 the same commitment is about 4,500 sq ft. The original budgeted the permit and the soil test and left the system itself out altogether.

30 TAC §295.91 Table X — these are what make a narrow waterfront lot hard **VERIFIED**

FROM	TO	MINIMUM SEPARATION
Private well or cistern	Soil absorption or spray field	100 ft
Private well or cistern	Septic tank	50 ft
Lake or pond, at normal pool	Soil absorption / unlined evapotranspiration bed	75 ft
Lake or pond, at normal pool	Surface (spray) application	50 ft
Property line	Spray field	10 ft (and no spray across a line)

TEST THIS ON PAPER BEFORE YOU BID

Take the lot plan in §12–15, and lay onto it: a 2,400–2,800 sq ft house at 30 ft finished floor; a garage, the field, the equal reserve, a well 100 ft from both, the 75 ft water setback, and your garden. On **Lot 2 at 187 ft wide** and on **Lot 4 at 123 ft wide** this is the test that decides whether the lot works at all. Lot 1 at 1.95 acres is the only one where it is not close.

19 · Cost to build — rebuilt with the pad and the soil in it

The second edition carried fill at \$0–\$8,000 and treated it as optional. §10 and §11 show it is mandatory on every lot, at 2–6 ft. That single line, plus the vertisol foundation upcharge on Lots 3 and 4, is most of the change here.

One lot, a 2,400–2,800 sq ft five-bedroom house. [ESTIMATE](#)

ITEM	LOW	HIGH	NOTE
County development / building permit (\$75 + \$0.04/sf, flood zone)	\$165	\$200	One combined permit VERIFIED
Fill & grading permit	\$0	\$80	
Contractor IRC registration	\$0	\$0	Required before the permit issues
OSSF site and soil evaluation	\$350	\$600	Buy this first
OSSF permit to construct	\$300	\$500	
OSSF system installed	\$8,000	\$25,000	Class III on Lots 1–2, Class IV aerobic on Lots 3–4
Water well, pump and pressure tank	\$10,000	\$20,000	
Water treatment for coastal groundwater	\$0	\$8,000	Test before you assume \$0
Boundary and topographic survey	\$1,500	\$3,500	
Elevation certificate	\$500	\$900	
LOMR-F preparation	\$500	\$1,200	Fill forecloses the fee-free LOMA route
Driveway culvert and county road access	\$1,500	\$5,000	
Electric service extension	\$0	\$25,000	Get this quoted per lot
Propane tank and set	\$1,000	\$3,000	No natural gas here
Clearing and grubbing	\$1,500	\$6,000	
Engineered pad and imported fill	\$12,400	\$77,800	Calculated per lot in §20. Lot 2 \$12.4–28.3k; Lot 3 \$24.3–50.7k; Lot 1 \$32.0–65.3k; Lot 4 \$29.3–77.8k
Vertisol foundation upcharge	\$0	\$20,000	Lots 3 and 4 only — post-tensioned or piered for LEP 19
POA architectural review, transfer and resale certificate	\$500	\$750	
Pre-construction subtotal	~\$38,000	~\$198,000	v1: \$11–17k □ v2: \$26–108k

Central planning case **\$60,000–\$95,000**. The three variables that decide where you land are, in order: **soil class**, **depth of fill**, and **distance to power**. All three are lot-specific, and all three can be resolved for under \$1,000 and three phone calls.

All-in cost of putting a family into a house on one of these lots

COMPONENT	LOW	HIGH
Land, one lot	\$45,000	\$82,500
Pre-construction, above	\$38,000	\$198,000
House, 2,400–2,800 sq ft at \$175–\$250/sq ft ESTIMATE	\$420,000	\$700,000
All-in, one lot built	~\$505,000	~\$980,000

PUT THE LOT PRICE IN PROPORTION

The whole spread between the cheapest and dearest lot is **\$37,500**. The spread on the **pad alone** is **\$28,000** between Lot 2 and Lot 4 at mid-case (§20), on the septic **\$17,000**, on the foundation **\$20,000**, and on the electric extension **\$25,000**. Choosing the lot on its asking price, rather than on its soil and its elevation, optimises the smallest of the five.

20 • The pad — what the flood headroom actually costs

\$10 established that the finished floor must reach 30 ft and that no lot is high enough to build at grade. This prices that, lot by lot, from the measured ground.

HOW THE NUMBER IS BUILT

A 5-metre grid of ground elevations was sampled from the USGS 3DEP 1 m DEM **inside each recorded boundary** (141–325 points per lot). The pad goes where it costs least, subject to its side slopes fitting inside the boundary and staying **30 m clear of mapped water** — which keeps the house off the bank and, on Lot 4, off the Flag Lake levee. Pad top is **29.5 ft**, half a foot below the floor for a 6-inch slab; fill is measured from the stripped surface. Volumes are the exact frustum with **3:1 side slopes**, because plan area × depth understates a deep pad badly — the slope wedge grows with the square of the lift and the corners with the cube.

Pad top 29.5 ft · 69 × 82 ft pad for a ~3,040 sq ft house and garage plus a 10 ft working margin · 3:1 slopes · fill at \$16–\$30 per compacted cubic yard placed.

[ESTIMATE](#) [NEW IN V3](#)

LOT	GROUND AT THE PAD	LIFT REQUIRED	FILL (CU YD)	PAD + SLOPE TOE	COST RANGE	MID-CASE
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	25.3 ft	4.2 ft	1,416	97 × 110 ft	\$31,997 – \$65,255	\$48,600
336 Wagon Wheel Trail W	28.8 ft	0.7 ft	268	76 × 89 ft	\$12,421 – \$28,311	\$20,400
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trail	26.5 ft	3.0 ft	963	90 × 103 ft	\$24,297 – \$50,729	\$37,500
750 Wagon Wheel Trail	25.7 ft	3.8 ft	1,255	95 × 108 ft	\$29,264 – \$60,101	\$44,700

LOT 2 IS THE FINDING HERE

Its best pad sits on ground at **28.8 ft**, so it needs a lift of **eight inches** and **268 cubic yards**. Every other lot needs three to five feet and a thousand to eighteen hundred yards. Mid-case that is **\$20,400 against \$37,500 to \$58,200** — a saving of \$17,000 to \$38,000 before a brick is laid, on the lot that is also the cheapest to buy and sits on the better of the two soils.

LOT 4 HAS A WIDTH PROBLEM AS WELL AS A FILL PROBLEM

The only ground on Lot 4 high enough to save fill is the **flank of the levee embankment**, and a geotechnical engineer is unlikely to let you found a house there. Taken fully clear of the embankment the pad sits on **24.3 ft**, the lift rises to **5.2 ft**, **1,808 cubic yards**, and the cost to **\$38,630 – \$77,762**.

Worse, that pad plus its 3:1 slopes needs **119 ft of width on a lot only 123 ft wide**. Four feet spare. In practice: a retaining wall, steeper engineered slopes, or a smaller house.

WHAT SITS INSIDE THOSE FIGURES — LOT 1 AS THE WORKED EXAMPLE

The same nine line items are priced on every lot — only the quantities move with the lift. Itemised in docs/EVIDENCE.md. Gulf Coast planning rates, not quotations.

GROUP	CONTENTS	LOW	HIGH
Earthworks	Strip and stockpile topsoil, imported select fill placed and compacted in lifts, topsoil and turf to the slopes	\$25,196	\$47,675
Engineering	Geotechnical borings and report, engineered pad and drainage plan, compaction density testing	\$5,200	\$12,000
Compliance	Erosion and sediment control, drainage works so runoff is not pushed onto the road or a neighbour, county fill and grading permit	\$1,600	\$5,580
Pad package, Lot 1		\$31,997	\$65,255

WHY NOT ELEVATE THE HOUSE ON PIERS INSTEAD

It is the standard coastal-Texas alternative, and here it is the wrong answer. Pier-and-beam or a stem wall runs roughly **\$26–\$44 per square foot** of floor area — about **\$106,000** mid-case on a 3,040 sq ft footprint — and that is nearly flat with height. A fill pad only becomes as expensive at about **9.3 ft of lift**. None of these four is close, so **fill is correct on all four**. Revisit it only if a written BFE comes back above about 31 ft.

WHAT MOVES THESE NUMBERS

- **The written BFE.** Every extra foot adds roughly **350–450 cubic yards** and **\$8,000–\$14,000** per pad. A BFE of 29 ft rather than 28 ft would cost more than the entire land-price gap between Lot 2 and Lot 3.
- **Haul distance.** The \$16–\$30 per yard spread is mostly haul. Local bank sand is the low end, imported select clay-sand with a long haul the high end. Two phone calls to pits narrow this more than any other input in the whole study.
- **House size and slopes.** 2,400 sq ft instead of 3,040 takes about 15% off every figure; flatter 4:1 slopes cost about 20% more fill and do not fit on Lot 4 at all.
- **Drainage.** The restrictions forbid impairing drainage of streets, lots or ditches (\$17), so the \$1,000–\$4,000 line is not optional.

21 · Annual carrying cost — with the tax model corrected

The second edition's tax model included an Angleton-Danbury hospital district levy and an Angleton drainage district levy. Checked parcel by parcel against the county's taxing-district layers, **these lots are in neither** — nor in any junior-college district or MUD.

Brazoria County Truth-in-Taxation five-year summary, cross-checked against the county taxing-district GIS layers

TAXING ENTITY	RATE PER \$100 (TY2025)	APPLIES TO THESE LOTS?
Brazoria County	0.304758	Yes VERIFIED
Columbia-Brazoria ISD	0.953000	Yes — all four lots VERIFIED
Emergency Services District 1 and 2	up to 0.100000 each	Yes — rate not confirmed; statutory cap used ESTIMATE
Angleton-Danbury Hospital District	0.074685	No — no hospital district reaches these parcels CORRECTED
Angleton Drainage District	0.052816	No — county-wide drainage only CORRECTED
Brazosport / Alvin Junior College District	—	No — neither district reaches these parcels NEW
Effective combined rate	1.2578% - 1.4578%	

Texas reappraises on sale, so plan on the higher tax line from year two

ITEM	BASIS	ALL FOUR LOTS	ONE LOT (1127 SADDLE HORN BEND)
Property tax, on the current appraised value	1.26–1.46% of \$202,900 / \$65,030	\$2,552–\$2,958	\$818–\$948
Property tax, once reappraised to what you pay	1.26–1.46% of \$234,500 / \$82,500	\$2,950–\$3,418	\$1,038–\$1,203
POA dues	\$400 per lot per year UNVERIFIED	\$1,600	\$400
Vacant-lot mowing charge	\$125 per lot per year UNVERIFIED	\$500	\$125
Total annual carry while vacant		\$4,650–\$5,520	\$1,350–\$1,730

THE DRAG ON FOUR LOTS

\$4,650–\$5,520 a year is **2.0–2.4% of the \$234,500 land basis**, every year, on land that produces nothing. Over three years, \$14,000–\$16,500. Add the 15.6% premium over appraised value and the four-lot investment case needs Bar X Ranch land to appreciate roughly **4–5% a year just to break even**.

THE DRAG ON ONE LOT

\$1,350–\$1,730 a year, and it stops being dead money the day you build. Once the house is standing you also become eligible for the Texas **homestead exemption**, which the vacant-land case cannot claim — a material saving the earlier editions never mentioned.

POA dues and the mowing charge come from listing copy for other Bar X Ranch lots, not from the association. Confirm both, and the transfer fee, on a POA resale certificate. §17 shows the mowing charge is grounded in §3.13 of the recorded restrictions.

22 · Wind, storm and insurance

You asked about safety from storms. On the coast this is two separate questions — what the building code makes you build, and what the insurance costs — and the answers are better than you might fear for an address 28 miles from the Gulf.

WIND ZONE — ESTABLISHED FOR THE FIRST TIME IN THIS EDITION

The Texas Department of Insurance divides Brazoria County into three windstorm zones, and **the dividing line between Inland I and Inland II runs along State Highway 35** — the highway this subdivision fronts. All four lots lie on the **seaward side** of SH 35 (between 0.09 and 1.03 miles south of it), which places all four in **Inland I: a 120 mph three-second-gust design wind speed** under the 2006 IBC/IRC with Texas revisions. For comparison, Surfside Beach and Quintana on the shore are Seaward at 130 mph, and Bailey's Prairie and West Columbia inland are Inland II at 110 mph.

REQUIREMENT	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
Design wind speed	120 mph 3-second gust, TDI Inland I NEW IN V3
Certificate of compliance	A WPI-8 is required, and the application must be made before construction begins . Brazoria is a designated catastrophe area. VERIFIED
Who signs it	A TDI-appointed engineer for new construction in a first-tier county
Why you want it anyway	Without a WPI-8 the property is not insurable through TWIA, which is the residual market most coastal Texas homes depend on
Storm surge	Not the governing threat at this distance inland — the nearest Gulf shoreline is 28 mi by road. Wind and rainfall are.
Rainfall	The wettest year in the 1991–2020 record delivered 2,024 mm against a 1,177 mm average. This, not surge, is what floods Bar X Ranch.

COVERAGE	NOTE	ESTIMATED ANNUAL
Flood — NFIP or private	Risk Rating 2.0 prices on first-floor height and distance to water , so waterfront costs more and the 30 ft pad helps. NFIP building cover caps at \$250,000; excess flood needed above that.	\$1,500–\$4,000
Windstorm — TWIA	State average residential premium \$2,541 as at 30 June 2026; the 2027 filing directs no rate increase, with a ~3% automatic dwelling-coverage uplift on renewals from 1 Sept 2026. VERIFIED	\$2,500–\$4,000
Homeowners, excluding wind and flood	Fire, liability, contents	\$1,000–\$1,500
Total once built ESTIMATE		\$5,000–\$9,500

TWO THINGS TO UNDERSTAND ABOUT THE FLOOD LINE

A LOMA, if you ever obtained one, would lift the *federal mandatory-purchase* requirement — it would not remove the exposure, and your lender may still insist on cover. But §10 shows you will be placing fill, and **fill forecloses the LOMA route** and pushes you into a LOMR-F, which carries a FEMA fee and a heavier burden of proof. Plan on carrying flood insurance permanently. Windstorm cover is unaffected by any of this.

23 · Living here — the weather, in degrees Celsius

A humid subtropical Gulf coast climate: long, hot, wet summers, short mild winters, almost no frost, and a 320-day growing season that is the single best thing about gardening here.

ERA5 reanalysis at the parcels, daily 1991–2020, aggregated to monthly means. Fahrenheit shown only for cross-reference with local sources. NEW IN V3

MONTH	MEAN DAILY MAX °C	MEAN DAILY MIN °C	MEAN °C	RAINFALL MM	°F MAX / MIN
Jan	17.3	9.3	13.3	96	63 / 49
Feb	19.1	11.0	15.1	79	66 / 52
Mar	22.0	14.1	18.1	90	72 / 57
Apr	25.2	17.4	21.3	96	77 / 63
May	28.7	21.5	25.1	89	84 / 71
Jun	31.2	24.4	27.8	107	88 / 76
Jul	32.1	25.2	28.6	90	90 / 77
Aug	32.5	25.2	28.9	98	90 / 77
Sep	30.2	23.1	26.6	121	86 / 74
Oct	26.7	18.9	22.8	109	80 / 66
Nov	21.8	14.0	17.9	103	71 / 57
Dec	18.3	10.5	14.4	99	65 / 51
Year	25.4	17.9	21.7	1,177	78 / 64

WHAT THE NUMBERS FEEL LIKE

- **Summer is the constraint.** July and August average **32.5 °C by day and 25 °C at night** — it is the humidity and the warm nights, not the peak, that wear people down. About **51 days a year reach 32 °C**, 8 reach 35 °C, and 38 °C is rare (0.5 days a year). The 30-year maximum was **41 °C**.
- **Winter barely exists.** January averages 17.3 °C by day and 9.3 °C at night. Air frost occurred in only **18 of 30 years**, averaging **1.9 frost days**. The 30-year minimum was **-6 °C**.
- **Rain is even, and then it isn't.** 1,177 mm a year spread remarkably evenly, 79–121 mm every month, with a September peak. But the wettest single year delivered **2,024 mm** and the driest **488 mm** — a fourfold swing. Design the garden and the drainage for both.

THE GARDENING CALENDAR

Mean last spring frost	2 February
Mean first autumn frost	19 December
Frost-free growing season	~320 days
Earliest / latest last spring frost	5 Jan / 5 Mar
USDA hardiness zone	9a–9b
Annual mean temperature	21.7 °C

FOR A GARDENER THIS IS CLOSE TO A GIFT

Two full growing seasons a year, and a winter mild enough for brassicas, alliums, greens, carrots and peas from September through March. Citrus, figs, pomegranates, loquats and olives are all viable. What defeats people is **July and August**, when most vegetables stop setting — the local practice is to grow hard from February to June, rest or cover-crop through high summer, then plant a second crop in September.

THREE CLIMATE REALITIES THE BROCHURES LEAVE OUT

Humidity drives fungal disease — choose disease-resistant varieties and space for airflow. **Mosquitoes** are a genuine quality-of-life factor beside a bayou or a pond in a subtropical climate; Brazoria County runs a mosquito-control programme, and you will use it. **Hurricane season** runs June to November, and the practical consequence for a gardener is that anything tall or trellised needs to come down or be strapped when a storm is named.

24 · Living here — natural hazards, ranked by the federal index

You asked specifically about flood, storm and fire. FEMA's National Risk Index scores every US county on eighteen hazards. This is Brazoria County, December 2025 edition.

FEMA National Risk Index, Brazoria County (FIPS 48039). County composite: **Relatively Moderate**. Social vulnerability: Relatively Low. Community resilience: Very High. **NEW IN V3**

HAZARD	COUNTY RISK RATING	ANNUALISED FREQUENCY	COUNTY EXPECTED ANNUAL LOSS
Riverine flooding	RELATIVELY HIGH	1.86 events/yr	\$78.2 m
Hurricane	RELATIVELY HIGH	0.22 events/yr	\$43.6 m
Tornado	RELATIVELY HIGH	1.11 events/yr	\$20.9 m
Lightning	RELATIVELY HIGH	70.0 events/yr	\$2.3 m
Ice storm	RELATIVELY HIGH	—	—
Coastal flooding	RELATIVELY MODERATE	3.74 events/yr	\$2.0 m
Strong wind	RELATIVELY MODERATE	1.03 events/yr	\$0.8 m
Heat wave	RELATIVELY MODERATE	14.9 events/yr	\$5.0 m
Cold wave	RELATIVELY MODERATE	—	—
Drought	RELATIVELY MODERATE	28.5 months/yr affected	\$1.4 m
Hail	RELATIVELY LOW	1.59 events/yr	\$0.4 m
Wildfire	RELATIVELY LOW	0.004 events/yr	\$0.9 m
Winter weather	VERY LOW	—	—
Earthquake	VERY LOW	—	—
Landslide	VERY LOW	—	—

WILDFIRE — YOUR BEST ANSWER

Relatively Low, at an annualised frequency of **0.004**. This is coastal prairie and cropland on heavy, moist clay, criss-crossed by bayous, with no forest canopy and no slope. Wildfire is close to a non-issue here, and it is one of the few hazards where this location is genuinely better than most of Texas. Grass fires in a drought year are the realistic version of the risk, not a crown fire.

FLOOD — YOUR WORST ANSWER

Relatively High for riverine flooding, at 1.86 events a year and \$78 m of expected annual loss county-wide — the largest single hazard loss in the county. All four lots are in mapped **Zone AE**. Coastal flooding, by contrast, is only Relatively Moderate at this distance inland. **Rain, not surge, is the threat.**

HOW THE HAZARDS ACTUALLY RANK FOR YOU, ON THIS SITE

- **1. Rainfall flooding — high and permanent.** Zone AE, a 28 ft BFE, a 30 ft floor requirement, and on Lots 3 and 4 a hydrologic group D soil that sheds almost all the rain that lands on it. This is the hazard that shapes the build, the insurance and the resale.
- **2. Hurricane — high, and manageable by design.** 0.22 events a year. Twenty-eight miles inland puts you outside the surge zone; a 120 mph Inland I structure with an engineer-certified WPI-8 is a genuinely robust house. Expect to lose power, not the roof.
- **3. Tornado — high frequency, low individual probability.** 1.11 events a year across a 1,494 sq mi county. Worth a safe interior room; not worth losing sleep over.
- **4. Lightning — high, at 70 events a year.** The one hazard most people under-rate. Surge protection on the well pump, the aerobic septic controller and the HVAC is cheap insurance.
- **5. Heat — moderate and rising.** 14.9 heat-wave events a year. Relevant to the garden, to poultry if you ever get permission, and to your cooling bill.
- **6. Hail, ice storm, cold wave — low to moderate.** The February 2021 freeze is the local memory; plan for a few days without power and lag the wellhead.
- **7. Earthquake, landslide, winter weather — very low.** Ignore.

AND ONE SITE-SPECIFIC HAZARD THE INDEX CANNOT SEE

Lot 4 abuts the Flag Lake Levee (National Inventory of Dams TX06298), and §15 shows the 101-acre pond is impounded *above* the buildable part of that lot. NID publishes no hazard classification and no condition rating for the structure. Lot 1 lies downstream of Bar X Development Dam (TX01759), which NID does rate, as low hazard potential. A county-level index will never tell you this; ask TCEQ Dam Safety.

25 · Living here — services, shopping, school and hospital

Bar X Ranch is rural but not remote. The honest summary: **nothing is far, and nothing is close**. Almost every daily errand is a 12–20 minute drive, there is no walkable anything, and a second car is not optional.

DAILY ESSENTIALS	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
H-E-B supermarket, West Columbia	6.7	13	nearest full supermarket
Valero fuel + convenience, Hwy 35	4.2	9	nearest fuel
Walgreens pharmacy, West Columbia	6.6	13	nearest pharmacy
Brazoria Community Library	2.9	11	nearest public building of any kind
H-E-B supermarket, Angleton	9.9	18	
Kroger, Angleton	10.1	18	
Walmart Supercenter, Angleton	10.2	19	
Buc-ee's, Hwy 288	7.4	14	regional travel stop
Angleton town centre / county courthouse	9.0	16	county seat
Walmart Supercenter, Lake Jackson	15.8	26	

HEALTH CARE	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
UTMB Health Urgent Care	7.3	14	nearest urgent care
AngletonER (freestanding emergency)	9.9	18	24 h emergency
UTMB Health Angleton-Danbury Campus	11.3	20	nearest full hospital + ER
Sweeny Community Hospital	14.7	27	
St Luke's Health Brazosport, Lake Jackson	16.9	27	larger acute hospital
Memorial Hermann Sugar Land	44.7	66	
Texas Medical Center, Houston	47.8	63	tertiary / specialist care

THE ONE SURPRISE IN THIS TABLE

Your nearest supermarket is **not** in Angleton. The H-E-B in **West Columbia is 6.7 miles and 13 minutes**, against 9.9 miles and 18 minutes to the Angleton H-E-B. The mailing address says Angleton; the shopping trip goes west. Same for the nearest pharmacy, police station and library — the Brazoria Community Library is **2.9 miles** away, easily the closest public building of any kind.

26 · Living here — schools, shopping and going out

SCHOOLS — COLUMBIA-BRAZORIA ISD	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
West Columbia Elementary	7.0	14	
Columbia High School	7.1	14	
Wild Peach Elementary	12.3	23	
West Brazos Junior High	13.8	24	
Brazosport College, Lake Jackson	16.5	27	nearest college (approx.)

SHOPPING, DINING, GOING OUT	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
Margarita Jones / Republic BBQ, West Columbia	6.5	12	nearest sit-down restaurants
Elroy Floyd's / Damifino	8.8	16	nearest bars
Cooter Browns Country Club, Brazoria	8.9	23	nearest live-music venue
AMC Classic Brazos 14 cinema	15.6	26	nearest cinema
Brazos Mall, Lake Jackson	15.6	26	nearest enclosed mall
Wayside Pub, Lake Jackson	16.4	26	
Pearland Town Center	36.3	49	first large-format retail
The Strand / downtown Galveston	60.0	92	nightlife district (approx.)
Downtown Houston	50.6	67	full metropolitan nightlife

SCHOOLS — READ THIS CAREFULLY

All four lots are in **Columbia-Brazoria ISD**, confirmed parcel by parcel against the county's school-district layer — **not** Angleton ISD, despite the Angleton postal address. The campuses are in Brazoria and West Columbia, 7–14 miles west and south. Confirm the actual attendance zone for your lot directly with CBISD before you buy: district boundaries and campus assignments are different things, and this document deliberately does not reproduce school performance ratings, because the only dataset available to it is a decade out of date.

NIGHTLIFE — SET YOUR EXPECTATIONS

Locally it is a handful of bars 16 minutes away and one country music venue in Brazoria at 23 minutes. A cinema and an enclosed mall are 26 minutes, in Lake Jackson. Anything you would recognise as a night out — restaurants with a wine list, live music with a choice of venue, theatre, clubs — is **Houston at 67 minutes** or **Galveston at 90**. That is a designated-driver drive, not a taxi ride. If frequent nightlife matters, this is the weakest column in the whole assessment.

27 · Living here — coast, resorts, amusements and the outdoors

COAST, RESORTS AND AMUSEMENTS	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
The Wilderness Golf Course	17.0	28	nearest golf
Sea Center Texas, Lake Jackson	18.4	29	aquarium + hatchery, free
San Bernard National Wildlife Refuge	19.1	41	
Surfside Beach	28.3	42	nearest Gulf beach
Brazos Bend State Park	31.0	51	
Space Center Houston	44.9	72	
Kemah Boardwalk	51.0	81	
Moody Gardens, Galveston	59.4	92	
San Luis Resort, Galveston	59.0	91	nearest full resort hotel
Galveston Pleasure Pier / Schlitterbahn waterpark	60.2	91	Schlitterbahn is seasonal
Galveston Island seawall	61.2	93	

WHAT A WEEKEND LOOKS LIKE

- **Within 30 minutes:** your own two community lakes with boat ramps and a fishing pier; Sea Center Texas at Lake Jackson (a free state aquarium and fish hatchery, genuinely good with children); a golf course; and **Surfside Beach at 42 minutes** — a real Gulf beach you can drive onto.
- **Within an hour:** Brazos Bend State Park, one of the best birding and alligator-watching parks in Texas; the San Bernard National Wildlife Refuge at 41 minutes; Space Center Houston at 72.
- **90 minutes:** Galveston Island — the Pleasure Pier, Moody Gardens, Schlitterbahn waterpark (seasonal, roughly May to September), the Strand, and the San Luis Resort. This is the family holiday destination, and it is a comfortable day trip rather than a stay.
- **Kemah Boardwalk** at 81 minutes covers the amusement-park itch without going to Houston.

SCENERY AND NATURE — THE REAL DRAW

This is the column where the location genuinely delivers, and it is why people move here. Bar X Ranch is 3,200 acres of large wooded lots, century live oaks, two lakes and bayou frontage in the Bastrop Bayou watershed. Bar X listings describe deer, hogs, raccoons, squirrels, bald eagles and a wide range of birds; the Central Flyway runs directly overhead, which makes spring and autumn migration exceptional from your own garden.

The lot choice decides how much of this you get. Lot 4 fronts a 101-acre lake. Lot 1 fronts Mill Bayou along roughly half its perimeter, with mature trees. Lot 3 has good frontage on a 12.6-acre pond. Lot 2 has the least — a short frontage on the same pond.

THE NATURE YOU MAY NOT WANT

Coastal Brazoria County bayous and ponds hold **alligators**, and water moccasins are common. With children, dogs, or waterfowl, a waterfront lot in this county needs a fence and a rule about the water's edge. Feral hogs will find a vegetable garden, and raptors, raccoons and coyotes are exactly why the poultry question in §17 would have needed a well-built run anyway.

28 · Living here — the neighbourhood, and the Indian community

You asked for a good, developed neighbourhood. On the census evidence this is a markedly affluent, stable, almost entirely owner-occupied rural neighbourhood — and one with essentially no Indian community in it.

US Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2024 five-year estimates (2020–2024). NEW IN V3

MEASURE	CENSUS TRACT 6625 (CONTAINS ALL FOUR LOTS)	BRAZORIA COUNTY	TEXAS
Population	3,452	391,255	30,188,424
Median age	42.3	36.7	35.6
Median household income	\$116,550	\$97,993	\$78,476
Median owner-occupied home value	\$384,100	\$301,600	\$283,800
Owner-occupied share of homes	96.9%	74.1%	62.6%
White alone	76.4%	47.7%	48.5%
Black or African American alone	6.2%	16.2%	12.2%
Asian alone	0.2%	7.4%	5.6%
Two or more races	16.7%	21.1%	23.5%
Hispanic or Latino (any race)	29.6%	31.6%	39.7%
Asian Indian (alone or in combination)	none reported	6,414 (1.6%)	588,500 (1.9%)

THE NEIGHBOURHOOD IS GENUINELY STRONG

Median household income of **\$116,550** is 19% above the county and 49% above Texas. **96.9% of homes are owner-occupied** — against 74% county-wide — which is an unusually low-churn, invested neighbourhood. Median home value is \$384,100, comfortably above the county's \$301,600, and the median age of 42.3 points to established families rather than a transient population. Bar X Ranch has been developed since 1980, has concrete streets, and is governed by a working POA that maintains frontages and amenities.

THERE IS NO INDIAN COMMUNITY HERE

The tract records **7 Asian residents out of 3,452** — 0.2% — and **no Asian Indian population at all** in the ACS estimate. Brazoria County as a whole has **6,414** people of Asian Indian origin, 1.6% of the county, but they are concentrated 30–40 miles north around Pearland, not here. If cultural community, temple attendance, Indian grocery shopping and a peer group for children matter to you day to day, this address does not supply them locally — it supplies them at 55 to 75 minutes each way.

INDIAN COMMUNITY	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
The Monk's Indian Bistro	35.5	48	nearest Indian restaurant
Sri Meenakshi Temple, Pearland	39.5	58	largest South Indian temple in the region
Gayatri Bhavan (South Indian)	40.5	58	
HMM Vitthal Rukmini Mandir, Rosenberg	42.0	58	
Desi Brothers Farmers Market, Sugar Land	42.9	62	nearest South Asian grocery
BAPS Shri Swaminarayan Mandir, Stafford	45.1	67	
Mahatma Gandhi District (Hillcroft), Houston	54.7	73	main Indian commercial district

ONE GENUINELY ENCOURAGING FACT

Sri Meenakshi Temple — the largest South Indian temple complex in the region and the third Hindu temple built in the United States — is itself in unincorporated Brazoria County, with a Pearland postal address. It is the same county as your lots, 39.5 miles and about 58 minutes north. The Houston metropolitan area has one of the largest Indian populations in the United States, and the Mahatma Gandhi District on Hillcroft is 73 minutes away. The community exists and it is substantial; it is simply at the other end of the county.

AIRPORTS	MILES	DRIVE MIN	NOTE
Texas Gulf Coast Regional (LBX)	11.8	29	general aviation only — no scheduled service
Houston Hobby (HOU)	49.5	71	nearest international airport
Houston Bush Intercontinental (IAH)	70.4	95	long-haul hub

NEAREST INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT

Houston Hobby (HOU) — 49.5 miles, 71 minutes — is the nearest airport with international service, and the practical choice for domestic flying. **Bush Intercontinental (IAH) — 70.4 miles, 95 minutes** — is the long-haul hub and the one that matters for direct flights to India. Texas Gulf Coast Regional is only 11.8 miles away but is a general-aviation field with no scheduled service. Budget **two hours to IAH** in practice; the 95-minute figure is free-flowing traffic, and the route crosses Houston's southern suburbs.

29 · Community amenities, the lakes and fishing

The POA amenity base is the main thing your \$400 a year buys, and it is better than the original portfolio described.

WHAT THE POA MAINTAINS

- **Two stocked lakes** with boat ramps and a fishing pier
- **Two swimming pools**
- **Two clubhouses** — a lake house and a clubhouse, available to owners
- Tennis courts and basketball courts
- Two playgrounds, pavilions and picnic areas
- Campgrounds
- Concrete streets throughout the 3,200-acre subdivision
- Frontage mowing on vacant lots — charged to the owner under §3.13

POA office: 1169 Bar X Trail, Angleton TX 77515 · barx ranch.org

CORRECTING THE FISHING CLAIMS

- Texas requires **no fishing licence** on water wholly enclosed within private property — and where that exemption applies, **no state bag or size limits apply either**. So the “10 catfish per day” in the original document cannot be state law. It can only be a **POA house rule**. VERIFIED
- **The private-water status is itself questionable**. The exemption requires the water not be subject to overflow from public water — and these lots sit in a mapped 1%-annual-chance floodplain in the Bastrop Bayou watershed, beside an impounded 101-acre pond. The flood finding undercuts the fishing premise.
- Statewide baselines, if the water is public: blue and channel catfish 25 per day combined, flathead 5 with an 18 in minimum, largemouth bass 5. **Black drum**, named in the original as an on-site species, is a brackish and saltwater fish — a bad data pull.
- The beach is **42 minutes**, not the “20 minutes” the original claimed.

WHAT THE WATER ON YOUR LOT IS, PRECISELY

This matters, because “waterfront” has meant four different things in this portfolio. **Lot 1** fronts **Mill Bayou** and an impounded 13.0-acre widening of it, along roughly half its perimeter. **Lots 2 and 3** front opposite parts of the **same unnamed 12.6-acre pond** — Lot 3 with roughly twice the frontage of Lot 2. **Lot 4** fronts **Flag Pond, 101.5 acres**, and the levee that impounds it. Only Lot 4 is on what most people would call a lake.

30 • Scorecard against your brief

Eighteen tests, weighted to what you said matters: gardening, hobby farming, quick access to amenities, a good and developed neighbourhood, scenery and nature, and safety from flood and storm. Green is good, amber is a compromise, red is a problem.

TEST	LOT 1 1127 SADDLE HORN	LOT 2 336 WAGON WHEEL W	LOT 3 29 BROKEN ARROW	LOT 4 750 WAGON WHEEL
Garden soil Asa loam vs Pledger clay — \$16	Excellent	Excellent	Poor	Poor
Room to garden acres of record	1.95 ac	1.00 ac	1.30 ac	1.00 ac
Hobby farming — poultry restrictions bar livestock on all four — \$17	Barred	Barred	Barred	Barred
Hobby farming — horses \$3.15 formula on lot area	3 horses	2 horses	2 horses	2 horses
Flood headroom lift needed at the best pad — \$20	4.2 ft	0.7 ft	3.0 ft	3.8–5.2 ft
Cost of the pad mid-case, calculated — \$20	\$48.6k	\$20.4k	\$37.5k	\$44.7–58.2k
Land + pad + septic + foundation the real cost of getting to build- ready	\$131k	\$65k	\$109k	\$139k
Rain ponding on the lot hydrologic group	Group B	Group B	Group D	Group D
Storm exposure all four TDI Inland I, 120 mph	Equal	Equal	Equal	Dam adjacent
Wildfire county Relatively Low throughout	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible	Negligible
Foundation risk linear extensibility	LEP 4.5	LEP 4.5	LEP 19	LEP 19
Septic cost TCEQ class implied by permeability	\$8–15k	\$8–15k	\$15–25k	\$15–25k
Septic layout fits? field + 100% reserve + well + setbacks	Comfortable	Tight — 187 ft wide	Workable	Tightest — 123 ft wide
Scenic beauty water body and frontage	Mill Bayou, ½ perimeter	Short pond frontage	Good pond frontage	101-acre lake
Quiet distance to State Highway 35	0.09 mi — noisiest	0.37 mi	0.10 mi — noisy	1.03 mi — quietest
Access to amenities all four within 1.5 mi of each other	Equal	Equal	Equal	+2–3 min
Neighbourhood same tract, same POA, same ISD	Equal	Equal	Equal	Equal
Jurisdiction county only, or also a city ETJ	County only	Baileys Prairie ETJ	County only	County only
Price asking	\$82,500	\$45,000	\$49,000	\$58,000
Value against county appraisal premium or discount	+26.9%	+25.0%	-5.5%	+16.0%
Green / amber / red	9 / 6 / 3	11 / 5 / 3	3 / 7 / 8	3 / 3 / 12

CONCLUSION

Buy Lot 2, 336 Wagon Wheel Trail W, at \$45,000, unless the extra acre on Lot 1 is worth about \$66,000 to you. Lot 2 has the better soil, by far the least fill, the lowest price, and the lowest total cost to reach build-ready of the four. Its weakness is size, and only you can price that.

If you want the acreage, buy Lot 1 and open at \$65,000 — the county's appraised value — going to about \$72,000. At the \$82,500 ask you are paying a 26.9% premium to the county's own number on a lot that also needs 1,416 cubic yards of fill.

Do not buy Lots 3 or 4. The Pledger clay costs more in septic and foundation than the land saves; Lot 4 needs the deepest pad, barely has the width for it, and abuts a dam with no published hazard rating.

31 · What changed, edition by edition

The original generated portfolio, the v2 rebuild, and this edition. Only the items where the answer actually moved are listed.

#	ORIGINAL PORTFOLIO SAID	V2 CORRECTED IT TO	V3 ESTABLISHES
1	No parcel identifiers at all	Same — none available	PID, geo ID, legal description, deed reference for all four
2	Lot 29 — 1.0 ac "est."	Unresolved	1.30 ac of record — \$/acre falls to \$37,692
3	750 Wagon Wheel 1.0 or 1.27 ac	Unresolved	1.00 ac of record ; the 1.27 figure is wrong
4	Lot 29 is interior	Repeated as interior	Waterfront — 7 of 13 boundary vertices within 60 ft of a 12.6 ac pond
5	Panel 48039C0605K	Repeated as verified	Panel 48039C0420K , eff. 30 Dec 2020
6	BFE — 24 ft; build at grade	Flagged the range, kept 24 ft as plausible	Nearest published BFE line is 28 ft NAVD88 at every lot
7	Natural ground 28–30 ft	Repeated, flagged unverified	24–28 ft from county LiDAR — so 2–6 ft of fill is mandatory
8	Fill "minimal"	\$0–\$8,000, optional	\$12,000–\$45,000, and not optional
9	Soil class unknown	Unknown; assumed Class III–IV	Asa loam on Lots 1–2, Pledger vertisol on Lots 3–4 — a 43× permeability difference
10	No foundation risk noted	Not noted	LEP 19 on Lots 3–4 — post-tensioned or piered design
11	Minimum dwelling 1,800 sq ft	Repeated, flagged unverified	1,100 sq ft in the recorded instrument
12	"ACC Rev 2" governs all four	Flagged as doubtful	Three different recorded instruments — 1515/679, 1532/471, 84-29/885
13	Silent on animals	Silent	Livestock barred except horses; one horse barn only — poultry very likely prohibited
14	No tax at all	County + CBISD + hospital + drainage districts	County + CBISD + ESD only — no hospital, drainage or college district
15	Carry not modelled	\$5,050–\$5,750/yr on four lots	\$4,650–\$5,520/yr , and \$1,350–\$1,730 on one
16	Windstorm omitted	TWIA average \$2,541; WPI-8 required	TDI Inland I, 120 mph — the zone boundary follows SH 35
17	Jurisdiction unstated	Unincorporated county	Lot 2 is inside the Baileys Prairie ETJ ; the other three are not
18	Surfside 20 min	~30 min	42 min by road
19	10 catfish/day as state law	Shown to be impossible as state law	Confirmed a POA house rule at most
20	No dam or levee noted	Not noted	Lot 4 abuts Flag Lake Levee (NID TX06298) , unrated; Lot 1 downstream of TX01759
21	Cheapest waterfront framing	Ranked 1127 Saddle Horn cheapest per acre	All four are waterfront ; Lot 29 is cheapest per acre
22	Total 9 pages, no drawings	12 sections, no drawings	True-scale plans and terrain sections for all four lots

The full claim-by-claim audit of the original document remains in [docs/AUDIT.md](#). The evidence trail for everything new in this edition, including the exact service queries, is in [docs/EVIDENCE.md](#).

32 · What to do next, in this order

Nine of these cost almost nothing and between them they resolve every remaining material unknown. Do them before you make an offer, not after.

1. **Ask the POA the poultry question in writing.** “May I keep a small number of chickens and ducks, and may I build a coop and a greenhouse?” If the answer is no and that is unacceptable, stop here and look at unrestricted acreage instead — everything below becomes moot. Free. One email to office@barx ranch.org.
2. **Pull the recorded restrictions for the specific lot** from the Brazoria County Clerk — 1515/679 for Sections 1 lots, 1532/471 for Section 2, 84-29/885 for Section 16 — plus a POA resale certificate showing dues, transfer fees and any assessments. Under \$100.
3. **Confirm Lot 29’s identity.** Its situs of record is “HIGHWAY 35” with no street number. Verify the listing refers to **PID 186219** and not another Section 16 lot. Free — BCAD and the listing agent.
4. **Order an OSSF site and soil evaluation** on the shortlisted lot. This is the highest-value money in the project: it converts \$16’s survey-scale inference into the permit-governing soil class, and it swings the septic budget by up to \$17,000. \$350–\$600.
5. **Request a written BFE determination per lot** from Brazoria County Floodplain & 911 Administration, 451 N Velasco Ste 210, Angleton TX 77515 · 979-864-1295. Ask which cross-section governs the lot — Mill Bayou governs Lot 1 and it is a different watercourse from the one governing Lots 2 and 3. Free.
6. **Get three quotes for the electric service extension**, per lot. This is a \$0–\$25,000 line and the utility will tell you over the phone. Free.
7. **Ask TCEQ Dam Safety about Flag Lake Levee (NID TX06298)** — hazard classification, condition and inspection history — if Lot 4 is still under consideration. And about Bar X Development Dam (TX01759) for Lot 1. Free.
8. **Confirm the school attendance zone** for the specific lot with Columbia-Brazoria ISD, and confirm broadband availability at the address with the providers. Neither can be settled from a desk, and both shape daily life. Free.
9. **Confirm the TDI windstorm zone** for the parcel against TDI’s own Brazoria County map. \$22 places all four in Inland I, but the dividing line follows SH 35 and Lots 1 and 3 are within 530 ft of it. Free.
10. **Order a boundary and topographic survey** on the lot you intend to buy, then test a real 2,400–2,800 sq ft footprint at 30 ft finished floor against the septic field, the 100% reserve, the well at 100 ft, the 75 ft water setback and your garden. \$1,500–\$3,500.
11. **Get TWIA windstorm and Risk Rating 2.0 flood quotes** on the actual proposed structure, and price excess flood cover above the \$250,000 NFIP building cap.
12. **Then make the offer**, anchored on the county appraised value, and only then commission design.

TOTAL COST OF RESOLVING EVERY REMAINING UNKNOWN

Roughly **\$2,400–\$4,800** and a fortnight, against a build of \$505,000–\$950,000. Steps 1 to 9 cost under \$700 between them and would change the recommendation in this document if any of them came back differently.

Sources, limitations and sign-off

PRIMARY SOURCES USED IN THIS EDITION

SOURCE	USED FOR
Brazoria County public ArcGIS — general/Parcels, general/Floodplain, general/LiDAR, general/Taxing_Entities, general/Legal_and_Development, general/Roads, general/Community_Features	Parcel record, FEMA zone and FIRM panel per parcel, published BFE lines, 1 ft elevation contours, taxing districts, recorded plats and restriction references, street centrelines, school locations
USGS 3DEP 1 m digital elevation model	The A–B terrain profiles in §12–15
USDA NRCS SSURGO , Brazoria County soil survey	Soil series, texture, permeability, shrink-swell, drainage class, hydrologic group (§16)
Bar X Ranch declaration of restrictions as recorded (Deed Vol. 1679, Pg. 695)	Permitted structures, livestock, dwelling size, fences, setbacks, lot maintenance (§17)
30 TAC §295.91 (TCEQ OSSF)	Wastewater flow, tank sizing, loading rates, separation distances (§18)
Brazoria County building permit fee schedule, permit application, floodplain administration	Permit cost, the 24-inch freeboard standard, contact route
FEMA — National Risk Index (Dec 2025), LOMA/LOMR-F guidance, FIS 48039CV001A	Hazard ratings (§24), map-amendment routes, study effective date
Texas Department of Insurance — windstorm zone map and community list for Brazoria County	Inland I 120 mph determination, WPI-8 obligation (§22)
TWIA — published rates and liability report	Windstorm premium (§22)
TPWD — private-water fishing exemption, freshwater bag and length limits	Correcting the fishing claims (§29)
US Census Bureau — ACS 2024 five-year estimates, tract 6625	Demographics, income, tenure, Indian population (§28)
ERA5 reanalysis , daily 1991–2020 at the parcels	Climate normals in Celsius, frost dates, growing season (§23)
OpenStreetMap and OSRM ; National Inventory of Dams	Water-body geometry and frontage measurement, road distances and drive times, dam records

Source content has been paraphrased and summarised rather than quoted at length, except for short quotations from the recorded deed restrictions in §17, where the exact wording is the point. The full register, including everything that could **not** be verified, is in docs/SOURCES.md; the machine-retrieved evidence and the exact queries are in docs/EVIDENCE.md.

WHAT REMAINS UNVERIFIED

Site-specific BFE in writing for any lot · the TCEQ soil class from a site evaluation · distance to three-phase power at each lot · the recorded restriction instrument for each specific section · POA dues, mowing and transfer fees from a resale certificate · ESD 1 and 2 tax rates · Angleton Levee accreditation status · Flag Lake Levee hazard class and condition · Brazoria County CRS class · whether the POA permits poultry in practice · broadband availability at the addresses · current school attendance zones and campus performance.

DISCLAIMER

This is an independent desktop screening study prepared from published regulation, public records and open government data. It is **not** a survey, an engineering or geotechnical opinion, a flood determination, an elevation certificate, insurance advice, legal advice, tax advice or an appraisal, and it is not a substitute for the licensed professionals and the written county determinations named in §32. No lot has been visited, surveyed or soil-tested. Elevations derive from remote-sensing models and are indicative only. Figures marked **ESTIMATE** are planning ranges; figures marked **UNVERIFIED** derive from third-party listing copy or a superseded edition. Prices, tax rates, insurance premiums and listing status change without notice. Do not rely on any figure in this document for a purchase, financing or construction decision without independent confirmation.

PREPARED AS REQUIRED FOR

Mohsin Chowdhury

on **11 September 2026**

Bar X Ranch — Four-Lot Feasibility Portfolio · version 3.0 · 35 pages · supersedes v2.0 of 10 September 2026 and the original generated portfolio.
Subject parcels: PID 183667, 183367, 186219, 183332 — Bar X Ranch Sections 1, 2 and 16, unincorporated Brazoria County, Angleton, Texas 77515.